

TOEFL iBT 2026 · 132-Day Sprint Plan

Personal study plan

2026-05-17 → 2026-09-26

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TOEFL iBT 2026 · 132-Day Sprint Plan

Exam date: 2026-09-26 (Saturday), 08:00 AM **Start date:** 2026-05-17 **Total:**
 132 days / ~19 weeks / 9 bi-weekly chapters + 1 final-week tune-up **Target**
score: 100+ (CEFR C1) **Daily commitment:** 90 minutes

0 · Why this book exists

On **2026-01-21**, ETS launched a completely redesigned **Adaptive TOEFL iBT**. The exam you'll sit in September is this new version — not an updated old TOEFL but a different game with different rules:

Total length - Old: ~120 min - **New: 90 min**

Reading / Listening - Old: Fixed items - **New: Adaptive** — **Module 1 difficulty determines Module 2**

Speaking tasks - Old: 4 tasks (Independent + Integrated) - **New: 2 tasks** — **Listen & Repeat (7 items) + Interview (4 items)**

Speaking prep time - Old: Yes - **New: None**

Writing tasks - Old: Integrated + Academic Discussion - **New: Build a Sentence + Email + Academic Discussion**

Score - Old: 0–120 - **New: 1–6 CEFR band** (0–120 also reported for 2 years)

Score delivery - Old: 6–10 days - **New: 72 hours**

Templated answers - Old: Workable - **New: AI detects them → penalty**

Three rules that run through every chapter:

1. **Early items are not equal.** The adaptive engine punishes Module 1 mistakes more heavily. All “accuracy training” in this book targets the early items.
2. **Real input beats drill.** ETS’s own research (Liu, 2014; see `resources.md` § R-REF-1) found coaching attendance has near-zero correlation with score. **Total real-English exposure** is the main driver. Every week includes real material (academic podcasts, TED, Coursera).
3. **No templates.** The new AI scorer penalizes templated language. This book trains **structural thinking** (Email 4-part frame, Discussion PEEL reasoning) — not phrases to memorize.

1 · Methodology (evidence-based)

1.1 Shadowing

Originated in 1990s Japanese/Korean EFL pedagogy. Meta-analyses (Hamada 2016; Tandfonline 2025 systematic review) show: - **10–15 min/day × 4–6 weeks** → measurable gains in listening comprehension, fluency, pronunciation - **Directly maps** to Listen & Repeat (the new 7/11 Speaking items) - This book reserves **15 min/day for shadowing**. See `resources.md` § 4 for sources and the 3-pass protocol.

1.2 Spaced repetition (Anki)

- Vocabulary is the floor; everything else stacks on it.

- Decks: **4000 Essential English Words** (general) + **Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL** (academic).
- 15 min/day = 20 new + ~60 reviews. See `resources.md` § 3.

1.3 Adaptive test strategy

- **Module 1 accuracy > speed.** Push hard early to unlock harder Module 2 (= higher ceiling).
- **Error log with attribution.** For every wrong answer, tag it: *knowledge gap* / *careless* / *time pressure*. Careless errors hurt most.
- **No templates.** But do learn **frames**: Email (greeting → context → ask → close), Discussion (Point → Evidence → Explain → Link).

1.4 AI tool stack

Picked one per role; see `resources.md` § 2 for full catalog.

- **Official mock + scoring:** ETS TestReady — only platform with the actual scoring engine
- **Conversational speaking coach:** PrepEx (Petra AI) — fixes the “no prep time” problem; live dialogue
- **Cross-section AI scoring:** FluentPrep AI — ETS-rubric-aligned, 900+ items
- **Vocabulary:** Anki + shared decks — proven spaced-repetition algorithm
- **Writing polish:** ChatGPT / Claude — grammar/idea feedback only; **never trust their scores**
- **Shadowing source:** TED-Ed / 60-Second Science — transcript-bundled, ~C1 register

2 · The 90-Minute Daily Template (the iron rule)

2.1 Daily time blocks

00:00–00:15	■ Anki vocabulary	(20 new + ~60 reviews)
← every day		
00:15–00:30	■ Shadowing	(Listening + Speaking combined)
← every day		
00:30–01:00	■ Day's MAIN skill	(30 min – rotates per § 2.2)
01:00–01:20	■ Day's SECONDARY skill	(20 min – rotates per § 2.2)
01:20–01:30	■ Error log	(3 lines: what / why / how to avoid next time)

Note: **Anki already covers vocabulary (foundation for all 4 skills). Shadowing already trains Listening + Speaking simultaneously.** So the “Main + Secondary” 30+20-min blocks are **additional** focused work on top of those two foundations.

2.2 Weekly skill rotation (iron rule: all four skills touched every week)

- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading (30 min) · SECONDARY = Writing (20 min) · Touches: R, W, L+S (shadowing)
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening (30 min) · SECONDARY = Speaking (20 min) · Touches: L, S, L+S
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing (30 min) · SECONDARY = Reading (20 min) · Touches: W, R, L+S
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking (30 min) · SECONDARY = Listening (20 min) · Touches: S, L, L+S
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading (30 min) · SECONDARY = Speaking (20 min) · Touches: R, S, L+S
- **Saturday** · MAIN = Listening + Speaking combined (30 min) · SECONDARY = Writing (20 min) · Touches: L, S, W
- **Sunday** · MAIN = Writing — Email or Discussion (30 min) · SECONDARY = Short mock + weekly review (20 min) · Touches: W + full skill recap

Weekly skill count (MAIN sessions): R×3, L×3, W×3, S×3 + 1 combined ⇒ **every skill ≥ 3 focused sessions per week.**

2.3 Sunday extra: review + short mock

Sundays use 30 min for a short TPO-style segment (~10 reading items OR 8 listening items OR 1 writing task), with the remaining time on error-log review. This is where weekly practice **converts into score.**

2.4 The floor rules

- **Anki + Shadowing never get skipped.** They are the floor. Break either for 3 consecutive days and the whole system collapses.
 - **The error log matters more than item count.** Practice without review = zero.
-

3 · 9 Chapters + 1 Week — Roadmap

 **Important:** Each chapter's "theme" is an **emphasis on top of** the weekly rotation — not "this chapter only practices one skill." The § 2.2 rotation is always in effect. The chapter theme just shifts MAIN sessions toward the focus skill.

Ch.1 — 5/17 to 5/30 (14 days) - Emphasis: Diagnosis + system setup (4-skill baseline) - Deliverable: Weak-skill profile + tools live

Ch.2 — 5/31 to 6/13 (14 days) - Emphasis: Listening + high-frequency vocabulary - Deliverable: TPO listening baseline

Ch.3 — 6/14 to 6/27 (14 days) - Emphasis: Reading + academic vocabulary - Deliverable: Reading Module 1 $\geq 85\%$ accuracy

Ch.4 — 6/28 to 7/11 (14 days) - Emphasis: Speaking — Listen & Repeat focus - Deliverable: 7-item exact-repeat rate $\geq 80\%$

Ch.5 — 7/12 to 7/25 (14 days) - Emphasis: Writing — Email + Build a Sentence - Deliverable: Email 100 words in 10 min

Ch.6 — 7/26 to 8/8 (14 days) - Emphasis: Speaking — Interview + AI dialogue - Deliverable: Structured 45-sec Interview answer

Ch.7 — 8/9 to 8/22 (14 days) - Emphasis: Writing — Academic Discussion - Deliverable: 200-word Discussion in 10 min

Ch.8 — 8/23 to 9/5 (14 days) - Emphasis: Adaptive realism — Module 1 mastery - Deliverable: 4-skill Module 1 accuracy on target

Ch.9 — 9/6 to 9/19 (14 days) - Emphasis: Full mocks $\times 4$ + error attribution - Deliverable: Stable mock score ≥ 100

Final Week — 9/20 to 9/26 (7 days) - Emphasis: Pre-exam tune-up + state management - Deliverable: Peak on exam morning

What "emphasis" means in practice: in Ch.2 (Listening focus week), the Monday "MAIN = Reading" slot temporarily becomes "MAIN = Listening." Across the week, Listening MAIN sessions go from 2 $\rightarrow$ 4. But **Reading, Writing, Speaking**

each still get ≥ 2 MAIN sessions + daily Shadowing + daily Anki. Each chapter's intro restates its modified weekly schedule.

4 • Evaluation Checkpoints (don't skip)

Baseline mock — Days 2–3 (5/18–19) - What: Full mock using R-OFF-2 (ETS Sample Test Jan 2026) - Target: Get a starting score

Milestone 1 — End of Ch.3 (6/27) - What: Reading Module 1 only - Target: $\geq 85\%$ accuracy

Milestone 2 — End of Ch.5 (7/25) - What: Listening + Speaking Listen-and-Repeat combined - Target: Listening $\geq 24/30$ raw, L&R $\geq 80\%$ exact

Milestone 3 — End of Ch.7 (8/22) - What: Writing — both tasks under exam time - Target: Email ≤ 10 min, Discussion ≤ 10 min

Mock weeks — Ch.9 (9/6–19) - What: 4 full mocks - Target: Stable total ≥ 100

Test day — 2026-09-26 08:00 - What: Real exam - Target: 100+

5 • Setup Checklist (do all of this on Day 1)

See resources.md § 8 for the full Day-1 setup list with exact URLs.

Quick summary: - ETS TestReady account (**R-OFF-1**) - Bookmark the free sample mock (**R-OFF-2**) for tomorrow - Anki desktop + import 4000 Essential English Words (**R-ANKI-1**) - One AI speaking tool — PrepEx (**R-AI-1**) or FluentPrep (**R-AI-2**) - Subscribe to 60-Second Science podcast (**R-SHAD-3**) - Choose where the error log lives (and don't switch)

6 • How to use this book

1. **Each morning:** open the current chapter file, tick today's checkboxes
2. **Each evening:** add to the error log (3 lines is fine — *what / why / how to avoid*)
3. **Every other Saturday:** complete the chapter's **bi-week review card** at the bottom of the chapter file
4. **If you miss a target:** push the lagging task into next chapter's early days — don't force progress

5. **Anki and Shadowing are not optional.** Anything else can be halved on a bad day; these two never stop.
-

7 • File map

toeflbook/	
├─ README.md	← you are here
├─ resources.md	← URLs, tools, decks (the catalog)
├─ ch01-diagnosis-and-system-setup.md	← 5/17–5/30
├─ ch02-listening-and-vocabulary.md	← 5/31–6/13
├─ ch03-reading-and-academic-vocab.md	← 6/14–6/27
├─ ch04-speaking-listen-and-repeat.md	← 6/28–7/11
├─ ch05-writing-email-and-sentence.md	← 7/12–7/25
├─ ch06-speaking-interview-and-ai.md	← 7/26–8/8
├─ ch07-writing-academic-discussion.md	← 8/9–8/22
├─ ch08-adaptive-module1-mastery.md	← 8/23–9/5
├─ ch09-full-mocks-and-attribution.md	← 9/6–9/19
└─ ch10-final-week.md	← 9/20–9/26

After all chapters are written, run `pandoc` to compile into a single PDF (`build.sh` will be included).

8 • References

- ETS TOEFL Research Series (Oct 2025 Technical Manual)
- Liu, O. L. (2014). *Investigating the Relationship Between Test Preparation and TOEFL iBT Performance*. ETS Research Report.
- Hamada, Y. (2016). *Shadowing: Who Benefits and How?* Language Teaching Research.
- ETS TOEFL TestReady (2026 adaptive version)
- Beyond English / Magoosh / My Speaking Score 2026 format guides

(Full URLs in `resources.md` § 7.)

Resources Catalog

Central index for every site, app, deck, and content source used in this book. When a daily task says “**Use R-OFF-1**”, look it up here for the exact URL and how to use it.

1 · Official ETS Materials (gold standard for 2026 format)

R-OFF-1 — ETS TOEFL TestReady (official platform)

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>
- **Price:** Free tier + paid items
- **Use case:** Daily practice, official scoring, AI feedback. **Required.**

R-OFF-2 — ETS Sample Test Jan 2026 (FREE full sample)

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html>
- **Price:** Free
- **Use case:** Use this for Day 2–3 baseline mock. Exact new-format.

R-OFF-3 — The Official Guide to the TOEFL iBT (book, latest 2026 edition)

- **URL:** <https://www.amazon.com/Official-Guide-TOEFL-iBT-Test/dp/1265477388>
- **Price:** ~\$25
- **Use case:** 4 full authentic practice tests in print.

R-OFF-4 — TOEFL iBT Test Content breakdown

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/about/content.html>
- **Price:** Free
- **Use case:** Reference for what every task looks like.

R-OFF-5 — TPO (TOEFL Practice Online)

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/practice-tests.html>
- **Price:** \$45.95 / volume
- **Use case:** Full-length retired tests. Buy 1–2 volumes once Ch.8 starts.

R-OFF-6 — TOEFL Test Prep Planner (8-week official plan, PDF)

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/pdfs/toefl/toefl-ibt-student-test-prep-planner.pdf>

- **Price:** Free PDF
 - **Use case:** Cross-reference for the final stretch.
-

2 · AI Feedback Tools (essential for Speaking/Writing)

R-AI-1 — PrepEx (Petra AI speaking coach)

- **URL:** <https://prepex.ai>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** **Conversational** speaking practice → perfect for Interview task.

R-AI-2 — FluentPrep AI

- **URL:** <https://www.fluentprep.online/>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** 4-section AI scoring using ETS rubrics; 900+ items.

R-AI-3 — TOEFLPrep.ai

- **URL:** <https://www.toeflprep.ai/>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** New-format full mocks + AI feedback.

R-AI-4 — CogniCircuit AI

- **URL:** <https://www.cognicircuit.com/>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** Real-time speaking + writing feedback.

R-AI-5 — ChatGPT (or Claude)

- **URL:** <https://chat.openai.com> / <https://claude.ai>
- **Price:** Free / Paid tier
- **Best for:** Grammar polish + idea brainstorming. **Do not** trust its scores.

R-AI-6 — My Speaking Score

- **URL:** <https://www.myspeakingscore.com>
- **Price:** Paid
- **Best for:** Speaking-only deep analytics (delivery, fluency); optional.

Rule of thumb: Pick **one** AI scorer (R-AI-1 or R-AI-2) and stick with it for trend tracking. Switching tools mid-plan ruins comparability.

3 · Anki Vocabulary Decks (spaced repetition)

R-ANKI-1 — 4000 Essential English Words (all 6 books)

- **URL:** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>
- **Word count:** ~4000
- **Use case:** **Base deck.** Start with Book 4–6 (B2+ level).

R-ANKI-2 — Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL

- **URL:** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>
- **Word count:** ~500
- **Use case:** **TOEFL-specific.** Start Day 8.

R-ANKI-3 — Essential TOEFL Vocabulary 500

- **URL:** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/39885404>
- **Word count:** 500
- **Use case:** Backup/alternative to R-ANKI-2.

R-ANKI-4 — Anki desktop download

- **URL:** <https://apps.ankiweb.net/>
- **Price:** Free
- **Use case:** Required to import shared decks. iOS app is paid (~\$25, worth it).

Daily Anki target (1.5 hr plan): 20 new + ~60 reviews ≈ 15 minutes.

4 · Shadowing Source Material (free, with transcripts)

Pick **one source per phase**; don't rotate too fast.

R-SHAD-1 — TED-Ed

- **URL:** <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>
- **Length:** 4–6 min
- **Difficulty:** C1
- **Best for:** Phase 1 (Ch.1–3) — rich vocabulary, animated, has transcript.

R-SHAD-2 — TED Talks

- **URL:** <https://www.ted.com/talks>

- **Length:** 8–18 min
- **Difficulty:** B2–C1
- **Best for:** Phase 2 (Ch.4–6) — natural speech rhythm. **Filter by 5–10 min** length.

R-SHAD-3 — Scientific American 60-Second Science

- **URL:** <https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>
- **Length:** 60 sec
- **Difficulty:** C1
- **Best for:** Daily 1-minute focused shadow; great for Ch.4 Listen & Repeat training.

R-SHAD-4 — BBC 6 Minute English

- **URL:** <https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/6-minute-english>
- **Length:** 6 min
- **Difficulty:** B1–B2
- **Best for:** Easier warm-up; use when burnt out.

R-SHAD-5 — VOA Learning English

- **URL:** <https://learningenglish.voanews.com/>
- **Length:** 3–5 min
- **Difficulty:** A2–B2
- **Best for:** Slower pace; skip unless basics are weak.

R-SHAD-6 — Language Reactor (browser extension)

- **URL:** <https://www.languagereactor.com/>
- **Best for:** Slows YouTube/Netflix down, side-by-side transcripts. Game-changing for shadowing.

Shadowing 3-pass protocol (do this every session)

1. **Blind shadow** — no transcript, 1 pass.
2. **Transcript shadow** — read along while shadowing, 1 pass.
3. **Recorded shadow** — record yourself + compare to original, 1 pass.

Research (Hamada 2016): 10–15 min/day × 4–6 weeks → measurable gains in listening + fluency + pronunciation.

5 · Free Practice Test Sources (when paid TPO not available)

R-FREE-1 — Magoosh free TOEFL practice test (2026 version)

- **URL:** <https://magoosh.com/toefl/toefl-practice-test/>
- **Format match:** High
- **Notes:** Free sign-up; full sections.

R-FREE-2 — BestMyTest free practice

- **URL:** <https://www.bestmytest.com/toefl/practice-test>
- **Format match:** Medium
- **Notes:** Quick drills.

R-FREE-3 — TestSucceed 2026 sample materials

- **URL:** https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new
- **Format match:** High
- **Notes:** Has examples for every new task type.

R-FREE-4 — ETS sample questions in TestReady free tier

- **URL:** (same as R-OFF-1)
- **Format match:** Highest
- **Notes:** Use first before any third-party.

R-FREE-5 — TOEFLResources.com 2026 templates & samples

- **URL:** <https://www.toeflresources.com/>
- **Format match:** High
- **Notes:** Good for Speaking/Writing **structure ideas** (do **not** memorize templates).

6 · Real-World Academic Input (the “general English exposure” multiplier)

ETS research (Liu 2014) found coaching attendance has **near-zero** correlation with score improvement. Total real-English exposure does. Build a weekly diet of:

R-REAL-1 — The Economist (Espresso free daily)

- **URL:** <https://www.economist.com/the-world-in-brief>
- **Use:** 5-minute daily read; complex prose.

R-REAL-2 — The Atlantic

- **URL:** <https://www.theatlantic.com>
- **Use:** Long-form, similar register to TOEFL Reading.

R-REAL-3 — Nature News / Science News

- **URLs:** <https://www.nature.com/news> · <https://www.sciencenews.org>
- **Use:** Scientific writing = TOEFL Reading clone.

R-REAL-4 — MIT OpenCourseWare lecture audio

- **URL:** <https://ocw.mit.edu/>
- **Use:** **Best free lecture audio** that mirrors TOEFL Listening lectures.

R-REAL-5 — Coursera free audit (any English-taught course)

- **URL:** <https://www.coursera.org/>
- **Use:** Long-form lectures + readings.

R-REAL-6 — NPR Up First / Hidden Brain podcasts

- **URL:** <https://www.npr.org/podcasts/>
- **Use:** Conversational listening.

R-REAL-7 — Khan Academy SAT Reading practice

- **URL:** <https://www.khanacademy.org/test-prep/sat>
- **Use:** Free academic reading drills, B2–C1.

7 · Reference / Research

R-REF-1 — ETS Research: Test Preparation effectiveness (Liu 2014)

- **URL:** <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/full/10.1002/ets2.12016>

R-REF-2 — Hamada (2016) Shadowing research review

- **URL:** <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/abs/10.1177/1362168815597504>

R-REF-3 — ETS 2026 TOEFL announcement & changes

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/about/test-changes.html>

R-REF-4 — Beyond English 2026 guide

- **URL:** <https://beyondenglish.com/the-2026-toefl-ibt-a-complete-guide-to-the-new-format-scoring-and-strategy/>

R-REF-5 — Magoosh 2026 changes

- **URL:** <https://toefl.magoosh.com/toefl-2026-changes>

R-REF-6 — My Speaking Score 2026 Speaking guide

- **URL:** <https://www.myspeakingscore.com/toefl-speaking-2026>
-

8 · Setup Checklist (Day 1 — do all of this)

- ☐ Create account on **R-OFF-1** (ETS TestReady)
- ☐ Bookmark **R-OFF-2** for tomorrow's mock
- ☐ Install Anki desktop (**R-ANKI-4**), import **R-ANKI-1** (start from Book 4)
- ☐ Create account on **R-AI-1** (PrepEx) — or **R-AI-2** if you prefer rubric scoring over conversation
- ☐ Subscribe to **R-SHAD-3** (60-Second Science) in your podcast app
- ☐ Bookmark **R-SHAD-1** (TED-Ed) — pick 1 video for Day 4's first shadow
- ☐ Decide where your **error log** lives (Notion page, markdown file, Apple Notes — pick one and don't switch)
- ☐ Optional: install **R-SHAD-6** (Language Reactor) browser extension

Total spend so far: \$0 (everything above has a free tier). Optional later: TPO volume (\$45) for Ch.8, Anki iOS app (\$25).

Ch.1 · Diagnosis & System Setup (5/17 – 5/30)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 5/17, Day 14 = Sat 5/30) **Theme:** Get tools installed, get a baseline, lock in habits **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills (Anki + Shadowing automatically cover vocab + L+S) **Deliverables:** 4-skill baseline scores + weak-skill profile + 90-min daily flow operational

1 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Tools live:** TestReady, Anki, Shadowing source, AI tool — all logged in
- **G2 — 4-skill baselines collected:** one scored attempt for R / L / S / W
- **G3 — Weak-skill profile:** can name in 3 sentences which skill is weakest, why, and what the first move is
- **G4 — Anki running:** decks imported, 7-day streak unbroken

- **G5 — Shadowing running:** ≥ 6 sessions done, mouth muscle memory starting to shift
 - **G6 — Error log started:** ≥ 5 entries, each with “why I got it wrong”
-

2 · This chapter’s modified weekly plan

Ch.1 is the “setup chapter.” Days 1–3 are **special** (install + baseline). Standard weekly rotation (README § 2.2) kicks in from Day 4.

Week 1 (5/17 – 5/23): Setup + diagnosis + ignition

- **Day 1 · Sun 5/17** — Tool install + read 2026 format spec · skills touched: R
- **Day 2 · Mon 5/18** — **Baseline mock: Reading + Listening** (90 min) · skills: R, L
- **Day 3 · Tue 5/19** — **Baseline mock: Speaking + Writing** (90 min) · skills: S, W
- **Day 4 · Wed 5/20** — Scoring + weak-skill profile + Anki ignition · skills: L, S (via Anki + Shadowing)
- **Day 5 · Thu 5/21** — Standard day: S MAIN / L SECONDARY · skills: S, L
- **Day 6 · Fri 5/22** — Standard day: R MAIN / S SECONDARY · skills: R, S
- **Day 7 · Sat 5/23** — Standard day: L+S combined / W SECONDARY · skills: L, S, W

Week 2 (5/24 – 5/30): Full rotation + bi-week review

- **Day 8 · Sun 5/24** — MAIN = Writing (Email first attempt) · SECONDARY = Short mock + review
- **Day 9 · Mon 5/25** — MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Day 10 · Tue 5/26** — MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Day 11 · Wed 5/27** — MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Day 12 · Thu 5/28** — MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Day 13 · Fri 5/29** — MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Day 14 · Sat 5/30** — MAIN = L+S combined + bi-week review · SECONDARY = Writing

Week 2 MAIN counts: R $\times$ 3, L $\times$ 3, W $\times$ 3, S $\times$ 4. Plus daily Anki + Shadowing → **all 4 skills hit ≥ 3 times in the week.**

3 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Default: 90 min/day. If a weekday is tight, drop the 20-min “real material” block; everything else holds. **Anki + Shadowing = floor.** Never skipped. Resource codes (e.g. **R-OFF-2**) point to `resources.md`.

Day 1 · Sun 5/17 — Tool install day

Goal: Every tool installed and openable

- ☐ **0:00–0:20** Create account at **R-OFF-1** (ETS TestReady — <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>). Take the 5-question survey to generate your free study plan.
- ☐ **0:20–0:35** Install Anki desktop (**R-ANKI-4** — <https://apps.ankiweb.net/>). Import “4000 Essential English Words” deck (**R-ANKI-1** — <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>). In Deck Options, set **New cards/day = 20**, **Maximum reviews/day = 100**.
- ☐ **0:35–0:50** Create account on **R-AI-1** (PrepEx — <https://prepex.ai>) or **R-AI-2** (FluentPrep — <https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Pick one and stick with it for the next 132 days.
- ☐ **0:50–1:10** Bookmark in your browser: **R-OFF-2** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html> — tomorrow’s mock) + **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons> — TED-Ed library).
- ☐ **1:10–1:30** Read the ETS 2026 format spec — **R-OFF-4** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/about/content.html>). Read at least the **Reading** and **Speaking** sections in full so you know tomorrow’s mock structure.

Error log: No items today. Instead, write one **prediction**: which of the 4 skills do you expect to be your weakest? Why? (You’ll compare against the actual baseline in Day 4.)

Day 2 · Mon 5/18 — Baseline mock R+L

Goal: Get scored on Reading + Listening, full new-format conditions

⚠ Today breaks the 90-min template. **Run the mock end-to-end** – no phone, no pauses.

- ☐ **0:00–0:45** Open **R-OFF-2** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html> → “Take the Reading section”). Complete the **full Reading section** (both Modules). Strict timing.
- ☐ **0:45–1:30** Without leaving the page, do the **full Listening section** (both Modules). Max 5 min break in between.
- ☐ **Evening +15 min** (optional): Score with the answer key, log raw counts and wrong-item IDs into your error log. **Don’t analyze why yet** – that’s Day 4.

Baseline table (write this in your error log):

Day 2 (5/18) Baseline – Source: ETS Jan 2026 Sample Test

- Reading: __ / __ Module 1: __ / __ Module 2: __ / __
- Listening: __ / __ Module 1: __ / __ Module 2: __ / __
- Wrong items: R [] L []

Day 3 · Tue 5/19 – Baseline mock S+W

Goal: Get scored on Speaking + Writing

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Open **R-OFF-2** → Speaking section → **Task 1 “Listen and Repeat”** (7 items). Listen once, repeat into your phone recorder. **Do not look at transcript.** Save the recording.
- ☐ **0:15–0:45** Same site → **Task 2 “Take an Interview”** (4 items, 45 sec each). **No prep time** – listen, then go. Record each one.
- ☐ **0:45–1:00** Open Writing section → do **Build a Sentence** items + the **Email** task (~100 words, strict 10 min).
- ☐ **1:00–1:30** Same site → **Academic Discussion** task (200 words, 10 min).
- ☐ **Evening +15 min:** Upload Speaking recordings to **R-AI-1** or **R-AI-2** for AI scoring. Paste both Writing tasks into the AI tool for rubric-based scoring. Log everything.

Baseline table (append to error log):

Day 3 (5/19) Baseline

- Speaking Repeat: __ / 7 (count “fully matched” repeats)
- Speaking Interview: AI score __ (Delivery __ / Language __ / Topic __)

- Writing Email: AI score ____ (Words: ____ Time: ____ min)
 - Writing Discussion: AI score ____ (Words: ____ Time: ____ min)
 - Hardest skill (gut feel): _____
-

Day 4 · Wed 5/20 — Weak-skill profile + Anki ignition

Goal: Turn yesterday's numbers into your 4-month script

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 First real Anki session:** 20 new + reviews. From **R-ANKI-1**, start with **Book 4** (B2 level — skip Books 1–3 unless you struggled with the baseline reading).
- ☐ **0:15–0:30 First Shadowing session.** Pick **one** TED-Ed video from **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) — recommend “How Do You Decide Where to Go in a Self-Driving Car?” or anything 4–5 min with science vocab. Run the **3-pass protocol**:
 1. Blind shadow (no transcript) — 1 pass
 2. Transcript shadow (read along while shadowing) — 1 pass
 3. Record-and-compare — 1 pass
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Build your weak-skill profile** (the core task today). Open your error log and fill this in:

Weak-Skill Profile (5/20)

Section scores (estimate against 0–120)

- Reading: ____/30 → CEFR ____
- Listening: ____/30 → CEFR ____
- Speaking: ____/30 → CEFR ____
- Writing: ____/30 → CEFR ____
- Total: ____/120

Weakest skill: _____

- Wrong-item patterns: _____ (e.g., inference questions, vocab-in-context, gist)
- My guess at why: _____ (e.g., vocabulary too small, can't catch connected speech)

Second-weakest skill: _____

- Wrong-item patterns: _____
- My guess at why: _____

Priority target by end of Ch.1: _____

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Real material:** read one *Scientific American 60-Second Science* transcript (**R-SHAD-3** — <https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>), then listen twice.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log: from Day 2's wrong items, pick 3 and write "why I got it wrong" (one line each).
-

 Day 5 · Thu 5/21 — Standard day (S MAIN / L SECONDARY)

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki: 20 new + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing: new TED-Ed video at **1.0×** speed first
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN** — Listen & Repeat drill. Use **R-OFF-1** TestReady free practice → Speaking → Task 1. 7 items. After each: record → self-rate (linking / stress / intonation) → re-record. If TestReady free tier is exhausted, fall back to **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new/en/templates/toefl-2026-new-speaking-templates.html) sample items.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY** — Use **R-OFF-1** → Listening → one Conversation set (5 items). Aim for ≥ 4/5 on first try.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log (3 lines)
-

 Day 6 · Fri 5/22 — Standard day (R MAIN / S SECONDARY)

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** TestReady → Reading → one passage (Module 1 set). **Strict 15 min for the passage.** Goal: train Module-1 speed and accuracy.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY** — Open **R-AI-1** (PrepEx) → Interview practice → 2 questions (45 sec each). Topics to ask Petra for: one "state an opinion" + one "recall a memory."
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

 Day 7 · Sat 5/23 — L+S combined / W secondary

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki

- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening + Speaking combined drill:** Pick a 5–8 min TED talk from **R-SHAD-2** (<https://www.ted.com/talks>, filter by 5–10 min). Listen once → record a 60-sec spoken summary into your phone → listen again to verify accuracy.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Open **R-FREE-3** → Build a Sentence samples (5 items) + write 1 Email (100 words, 10 min). Paste Email into **R-AI-5** (ChatGPT/Claude) → ask for grammar polish only.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Weekly mini-review** (not the bi-week review): which day was hardest to keep? Why?
-

Day 8 · Sun 5/24 — Writing Email first attempt

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — start adding cards from **R-ANKI-2** (Barron's TOEFL) here, 10 new from Barron's + 10 from 4000EEW.
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN** — Write 1 full Email under exam conditions. Prompt source: **R-OFF-1** TestReady → Writing → Email task, OR **R-FREE-3** → Email samples. **Strict 10 min.** Submit to **R-AI-1/R-AI-2** for rubric scoring.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Short mock — R-OFF-1** Reading → 1 passage Module 1 (5 items). Focus on accuracy not speed.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 9 · Mon 5/25 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing (15+15)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** TestReady → Reading 1 passage. After scoring, **attribute each wrong item** in the error log: knowledge gap / careless / time. Don't just look at the answer.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Build a Sentence × 5 items (**R-OFF-1** Writing section practice).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 10 · Tue 5/26 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing

- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN – R-OFF-1** Listening → 1 lecture set (6 items) + 1 conversation set (5 items).
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY – R-AI-1** Petra Interview → 2 questions on different styles: one **opinion**, one **describe your lifestyle**.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

 Day 11 · Wed 5/27 – W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN – Academic Discussion** 1 prompt (200 words, **strict 10 min**). Prompt: **R-OFF-1** or **R-FREE-3**. Score via **R-AI-2** (FluentPrep) → check **Topic Development** score specifically.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY – One *Scientific American* article (R-REAL-3 – <https://www.sciencenews.org>) + one *Economist Espresso* daily (R-REAL-1 – <https://www.economist.com/the-world-in-brief>). Read for comprehension, not items.**
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

 Day 12 · Thu 5/28 – S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN – Mixed drill:** Listen & Repeat × 7 + Interview × 2. Use **R-OFF-1** TestReady (Speaking section) – if exhausted, switch to **R-AI-1** Petra Interview mode.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY – R-OFF-1** → 1 lecture set, this time take handwritten notes during the lecture (mimics real test conditions where scratch paper is provided).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

 Day 13 · Fri 5/29 – R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN – R-OFF-1** Reading 1 passage (strict 15 min) **plus** one **Complete the Words** drill (**R-OFF-1** Reading section has this as a sub-task type – practice 1 paragraph with 10 missing-letter words).
- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY – R-AI-1** Petra Interview × 2 questions.

- ☐ 1:20–1:30 Error log
-

Day 14 · Sat 5/30 — 🎯 Bi-week review day

Today is different. Use the full 90 min on review, not new items.

- ☐ 0:00–0:15 Anki + reviews (floor — never skip)
 - ☐ 0:15–0:30 Shadowing — go back to the Day 4 video. Re-record and compare against your Day 4 recording. Hear the difference.
 - ☐ 0:30–1:30 **Bi-week review** — complete the **Ch.1 Review Card** below. Decide whether Ch.2 needs adjustments.
-

4 · Ch.1 Review Card (fill out on Day 14)

Ch.1 Review (5/30)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Tools all live
- [] G2 Baselines collected (R:___ L:___ S:___ W:___)
- [] G3 Weak-skill profile clear
- [] G4 Anki — 14-day streak unbroken
- [] G5 Shadowing ≥ 6 sessions done
- [] G6 Error log ≥ 5 entries with "why" attribution

Three numbers

- Anki cumulative cards learned: ____
- Shadowing sessions completed: ____
- Error log entries: ____

Three answers

1. Biggest discovery about my own English ability?
→
2. Which area lags the plan? Why?
→
3. What does Ch.2 (Listening + vocabulary focus) need to adjust?
→

"Modification orders" for Ch.2

- If Day 2 Listening < __/30 → Ch.2 bumps Listening MAIN from 2× to 4× per week
- If Anki is hard to keep → drop new cards from 20 → 15, ****but never**

stop**

- If Shadowing feels useless → switch to ****sentence-level intensive shadowing**** (one sentence, 5 reps each) for Ch.2

5 · Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **Don't read strategy tips before the baseline mock.** You want “naked score now,” not “score when prepared.”
2. **One Anki deck at a time.** Import 4000EEW first; add Barron's only on Day 8 once the habit holds.
3. **Shadowing week 1 feels terrible — that's normal.** Research shows real gains at 4–6 weeks. Don't quit at day 5.
4. **AI speaking scores are not truth.** They're reliable on delivery/fluency, weaker on topic development. Track the trend, not the absolute number.
5. **Don't wait to “be ready” to write the error log.** Write it tonight — 3 lines beats 0 lines by infinity.

Ch.2 · Listening Foundation + High-Frequency Vocabulary (5/31 – 6/13)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 5/31, Day 14 = Sat 6/13) **Emphasis:** Listening (on top of standard rotation). Vocabulary cadence raised. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Daily Anki = vocab floor. Daily Shadowing = L+S floor. **Deliverables:** Listening Module 1 $\geq 80\%$ on single pass + 200 new high-frequency words mastered + a note-taking system you trust.

1 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Listening Module 1 accuracy:** $\geq 80\%$ on a fresh R-OFF-1 Listening set
- **G2 — Note-taking system:** one system (T-chart or Cornell) used consistently in 6+ practice lectures
- **G3 — Vocab cadence:** Anki streak intact; 200+ new cards learned in chapter; mature card retention $\geq 85\%$
- **G4 — Conversation vs Lecture:** can score $\geq 4/5$ on conversations AND $\geq 5/6$ on lectures (single attempt, fresh material)

- **G5 — Shadowing focused on lectures:** ≥ 10 lecture-style shadowing sessions completed
 - **G6 — Error log discipline:** every listening error tagged with cause — vocab / speed / inattention / accent
-

2 · Modified weekly plan (Listening emphasis)

Standard rotation per README § 2.2 still applies. **Two changes for this chapter:**

1. **Shadowing source switches** from TED-Ed to lecture-style material — **R-REAL-4** (MIT OCW audio) or longer TED talks (**R-SHAD-2**, filter ≥ 10 min). Lecture register matches the test's Listening section.
2. **The Sunday MAIN slot** changes from Writing → **Listening micro-mock** (8-item Listening set in ~12 min).
3. **Anki pace:** still 20 new/day, but cards introduced from **R-ANKI-2 (Barron's TOEFL)** are prioritized this chapter for academic listening vocab.

Week-1 and Week-2 cadence (identical)

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Listening micro-mock** (8 items) · SECONDARY = Writing — 1 Email or Build-a-Sentence drill
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = **Listening** (lecture + conversation) · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = **Listening** (lecture, with notes)
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = **Listening + Speaking combined** · SECONDARY = Writing

Weekly skill counts (MAIN/SECONDARY/combined): - L: 3 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined = 5 focused touches - R: 2 MAIN + 1 SEC = 3 - W: 1 MAIN + 2 SEC = 3 - S: 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4

All four skills hit ≥ 3 focused sessions per week. 

3 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Resource codes (e.g. **R-OFF-1**) → see `resources.md`.

 Day 1 · Sun 5/31 — Listening micro-mock + Email warm-up

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new (10 from **R-ANKI-2** Barron's TOEFL + 10 from **R-ANKI-1** 4000EEW Book 5) + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing** — switch source: open **R-REAL-4** (<https://ocw.mit.edu/>), pick any short lecture excerpt (5 min) **or** **R-SHAD-2** TED Talk filtered 10–18 min. Run 3-pass protocol.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening micro-mock (8 items)** — **R-OFF-1** TestReady → Listening → 1 lecture set (6 items) + 1 conversation set (5 items, do first 2 of the conv set). Score immediately.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Email task: **R-OFF-1** TestReady → Writing → Email. 10 min strict. Submit to **R-AI-2** (FluentPrep) for rubric scoring.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log (3 lines)
-

 Day 2 · Mon 6/1 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing (MIT lecture clip)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** TestReady → Reading 1 passage. Strict 15 min.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Build a Sentence × 5 items (**R-OFF-1** Writing practice).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

 Day 3 · Tue 6/2 — L MAIN (lecture + conversation) / S SECONDARY

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** TestReady → 1 full lecture set (6 items) + 1 conversation set (5 items). **Use the note-taking system** you're testing this chapter (start with T-chart: left = main idea, right = examples/details).
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY** — **R-AI-1** PrepEx Petra → Interview × 2 questions.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — for each L wrong answer, tag cause: **vocab / speed / inattention / accent**.
-

 Day 4 · Wed 6/3 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN** — Academic Discussion 1 prompt (200 words, 10 min). Source: **R-OFF-1** TestReady → Writing → Discussion. Score via **R-AI-2**.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY** — 1 article from **R-REAL-3** (<https://www.nature.com/news>). Read for comprehension; note 5 unknown words → into Anki tonight.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 5 · Thu 6/4 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY (lecture, notes-focused)

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN** — Listen & Repeat × 7 (TestReady or **R-FREE-3** sample set). Record each, self-score for matched syllables.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY** — **R-OFF-1** → 1 lecture only. Goal today: pure note-taking practice. Score after, but the real product is your **notes** — keep them in your error log.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 6 · Fri 6/5 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** Reading 1 passage. Today try **Complete the Words** sub-task (10 missing-letter paragraph) if not done before.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY** — **R-AI-1** Petra Interview × 2 (one **opinion** + one **memory**).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 7 · Sat 6/6 — L+S combined / W secondary

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening + Speaking combined** — Pick a 10–15 min lecture from **R-SHAD-2** (TED Talks) OR **R-REAL-4** (MIT OCW). Listen once (notes only). Then **without re-listening**, record a 90-sec spoken summary including: main thesis + 2 supporting points. Re-listen → score yourself.
- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — 1 Email (10 min) from **R-OFF-1**.

- ☐ **1:20–1:30** Weekly mini-review: what's the *single most common* cause tag on your L errors?
-

Day 8 · Sun 6/7 — Listening micro-mock + Email

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening micro-mock (8 items)** — fresh set from **R-OFF-1**.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — 1 Email, 10 min.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 9 · Mon 6/8 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage, strict 15 min, **attribute** every wrong answer.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Build a Sentence × 8 items.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 10 · Tue 6/9 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 lecture (6) + 1 conversation (5).
Today: pick the **harder** module if TestReady offers a choice.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2 questions.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 11 · Wed 6/10 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN** — Academic Discussion, 10 min strict. AI-score via **R-AI-2**, **specifically check Topic Development**.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY** — 1 long-form article from **R-REAL-2** (<https://www.theatlantic.com>). 15-min read, no scoring.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

17 Day 12 · Thu 6/11 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:30–1:00 **Speaking MAIN** — Listen & Repeat × 7 + Interview × 2 (mixed).
 - ☐ 1:00–1:20 **Listening SECONDARY** — Lecture (6 items). **Compare today's note quality to Day 5** — keep them side-by-side.
 - ☐ 1:20–1:30 Error log
-

17 Day 13 · Fri 6/12 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:30–1:00 **Reading MAIN** — R-OFF-1 1 passage, strict 15 min.
 - ☐ 1:00–1:20 **Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2.
 - ☐ 1:20–1:30 Error log
-

17 Day 14 · Sat 6/13 — 🎯 Bi-week review + Listening showcase mock

- ☐ 0:00–0:15 Anki + reviews
 - ☐ 0:15–0:30 Shadowing (re-run a Day 1 clip; compare)
 - ☐ 0:30–1:10 **Showcase Listening mock**: full Listening Section (2 modules) from R-OFF-1. Strict timing.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 **Bi-week review** — fill the Ch.2 Review Card below.
-

4 · Ch.2 Review Card (fill Day 14)

Ch.2 Review (6/13)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Listening Module 1 ≥ 80% on showcase mock (Day 14) → actual: __/__
- [] G2 One note system used 6+ times
- [] G3 Anki streak intact; cumulative new cards: ____
- [] G4 Conversation ≥ 4/5 and Lecture ≥ 5/6 hit at least once
- [] G5 ≥ 10 lecture shadows done
- [] G6 Listening errors all cause-tagged

Pattern data

- Most common L error cause tag: _____
- Most common L topic missed: _____ (e.g., biology / art history /

economics)

- Conversation vs Lecture: which is harder? _____

Modification orders for Ch.3 (Reading emphasis)

- If L still below 80% on Day-14 mock → Ch.3 keeps 3 L MAIN sessions/week (don't drop)
 - If vocabulary tag is dominant → Ch.3 doubles down on ****R-ANKI-2**** Barron's
 - If accent/speed tag dominant → Ch.3 Shadowing moves to 1.25× speed
-

5 · Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **Don't replay a listening clip mid-attempt.** The test gives one pass — your practice must too.
2. **Notes aren't a transcript.** Capture structure (intro / 3 points / conclusion), not every word. Compare your notes to ETS's lecture outline (where provided) on Day 5 & 12.
3. **Anki fatigue is real.** If reviews stack above 100, **don't add new cards** until you're under 50 backlog. Better to skip new than drop reviews.
4. **Lecture vocab ≠ conversation vocab.** Lectures use formal academic register (e.g., *substantiate, predominantly, intricate*) — Barron's TOEFL deck is tuned for this.
5. **Speed isn't the problem early on.** Most missed listening items come from a single unknown word or distraction, not pace. Identify the cause before "trying to listen faster."

Ch.3 · Reading Foundation + Academic Vocabulary (6/14 – 6/27)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 6/14, Day 14 = Sat 6/27) **Emphasis:** Reading (on top of standard rotation). Academic vocabulary deepens. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing remain floor. **Deliverables:** **Reading Module 1 accuracy ≥ 85%** (this is **Milestone 1** from README § 4) + Complete-the-Words sub-task fluency + AWL (Academic Word List) top-200 absorbed.

1 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Reading Module 1** $\geq 85\%$: fresh R-OFF-1 Reading Module 1 set, single attempt
 - **G2 — Passage pacing**: one academic passage + 10 items in ≤ 15 min, comfortably
 - **G3 — Complete the Words**: $\geq 8/10$ on missing-letter task in one attempt
 - **G4 — Academic vocab**: 200 new Barron's/AWL cards mature in Anki (interval ≥ 4 days)
 - **G5 — Inference accuracy**: inference-question subset $\geq 75\%$ across chapter
 - **G6 — Listening doesn't backslide**: still hitting Day-13 Ch.2 level on a quick Listening drill
-

2 · Modified weekly plan (Reading emphasis)

Standard rotation per README § 2.2 still applies. **Two changes:**

1. **Shadowing source** transitions to **dense academic text** — pick *Scientific American* full articles (**R-REAL-3**) or longer TED-Ed (**R-SHAD-1**) covering science/history topics. Read-aloud variant allowed (you become your own audio).
2. **Sunday MAIN** changes to **Reading micro-mock** (1 passage, 10 items, strict 15 min).
3. **Anki**: 20 new/day, prioritize **R-ANKI-2** (Barron's TOEFL) and any AWL deck you find through **R-ANKI-1** Book 6.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Reading micro-mock** (1 passage) · SECONDARY = Writing — Email
- **Monday** · MAIN = **Reading** · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = **Reading** (Complete the Words drill)
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = **Reading** · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = Listening + Speaking combined · SECONDARY = Writing

Weekly skill counts: R = 3 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 Sun mock = 5 focused; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined = 3; W = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC = 3; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4. 

3 · Daily checklists (14 days)

17 Day 1 · Sun 6/14 — Reading micro-mock + Email

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new (15 Barron's + 5 4000EEW) + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing** — read-aloud a 60-sec **R-SHAD-3** transcript (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>). Record yourself; then shadow the actual audio.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading micro-mock — R-OFF-1** TestReady → Reading → 1 passage (10 items, strict 15 min). Log Module 1 accuracy.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Email, 10 min, score via **R-AI-2**.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

17 Day 2 · Mon 6/15 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage, strict 15 min. **Attribute every wrong answer:** vocab / inference / detail mis-read / time.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Build a Sentence × 8 items.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

17 Day 3 · Tue 6/16 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN — R-OFF-1** → 1 lecture + 1 conversation. Don't let L slip during R chapter.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

17 Day 4 · Wed 6/17 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY (Complete the Words)

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN** — Academic Discussion 1 prompt, 10 min strict. Score via **R-AI-2**.
- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY — R-OFF-1** TestReady → Reading → **Complete the Words** sub-task (10-letter blanks paragraph). Do 1–2 paragraphs.

- ☐ 1:20–1:30 Error log
-

 Day 5 · Thu 6/18 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:30–1:00 **Speaking MAIN** — Listen & Repeat × 7 + Interview × 2.
 - ☐ 1:00–1:20 **Listening SECONDARY** — 1 lecture from **R-OFF-1**.
 - ☐ 1:20–1:30 Error log
-

 Day 6 · Fri 6/19 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:30–1:00 **Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage, strict 15 min. After: pick the **inference questions** from the set and re-do them open-book — explain *why* the right answer is right.
 - ☐ 1:00–1:20 **Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2.
 - ☐ 1:20–1:30 Error log
-

 Day 7 · Sat 6/20 — L+S combined / W secondary

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:30–1:00 **L+S combined** — TED talk 10–15 min (**R-SHAD-2**). Notes during. 90-sec spoken summary after.
 - ☐ 1:00–1:20 **Writing SECONDARY** — Email, 10 min.
 - ☐ 1:20–1:30 Weekly mini-review
-

 Day 8 · Sun 6/21 — Reading micro-mock

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:30–1:00 **Reading micro-mock** — fresh passage from **R-OFF-1**, strict 15 min.
 - ☐ 1:00–1:20 **Writing SECONDARY** — Email or Discussion (your weaker one).
 - ☐ 1:20–1:30 Error log
-

 Day 9 · Mon 6/22 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing

- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage. Today try a passage you suspect is **harder** (Module 2 difficulty if TestReady marks it).
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence** × 8.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 10 · Tue 6/23 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.**
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — Petra Interview** × 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 11 · Wed 6/24 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN — Discussion, 10 min. R-AI-2** scoring.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY — R-REAL-3** *Nature News* article OR another Complete-the-Words drill.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 12 · Thu 6/25 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN — Listen & Repeat** × 7 + Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture.**
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 13 · Fri 6/26 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage, strict 15 min.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — Petra Interview** × 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log**
-

 Day 14 · Sat 6/27 — 🎯 Milestone 1 mock + Bi-week review

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + reviews

- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10** 🎯 **Milestone 1 mock** — full Reading Section (Module 1 + Module 2) from **R-OFF-1**. Strict timing. **This is the milestone test:** Module 1 $\geq 85\%$ required to proceed without remediation.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Ch.3 Review Card below.
-

4 · Ch.3 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.3 Review (6/27) – Milestone 1

Milestone 1: Reading Module 1

- Score: ___ / ___ → %: ___
- ****PASS**** ($\geq 85\%$) / ****HOLD**** (75–84%, do 1 more week of R drills in Ch.4) / ****REDO**** ($< 75\%$, extend R focus into Ch.4)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Module 1 $\geq 85\%$
- [] G2 1 passage ≤ 15 min comfortable
- [] G3 Complete-the-Words $\geq 8/10$
- [] G4 200 new Anki cards mature
- [] G5 Inference subset $\geq 75\%$
- [] G6 Listening hasn't slipped

Pattern data

- Most common R error cause tag: _____
- Most common R question type missed: _____ (inference / vocab-in-context / detail / negative-fact / paragraph-purpose)
- Average time per passage: ___ min

Modification orders for Ch.4 (Speaking – Listen & Repeat)

- If Milestone 1 = REDO → keep Reading MAIN at 3×/week in Ch.4 (don't drop to 2)
 - If inference-type errors dominate → add 5-min "inference logic" warm-up daily in Ch.4
 - If Complete-the-Words $< 8/10$ → daily 1-paragraph CtW drill, every day in Ch.4
-

5 • Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **“I understand the passage” ≠ “I’ll get the questions right.”** Comprehension and question-targeting are separate skills. Train them separately: read for gist → re-read for the specific question’s evidence.
2. **Vocab-in-context is a free point** if your Anki habit holds. If you’re missing those, you’re behind on Anki, not on reading.
3. **Inference is not guessing.** Every inference answer is supported by a specific line in the text. Train yourself to **point to the line** before locking an answer.
4. **Complete the Words tests morphology + spelling, not meaning.** Practice prefixes/suffixes separately; many missed letters are predictable from word family (e.g., *-tion*, *-ment*, *un-*, *in-*).
5. **Don’t skip Listening this chapter.** The Ch.2 gains evaporate in 2 weeks if you stop.

Ch.4 • Speaking — Listen & Repeat Focus (6/28 – 7/11)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 6/28, Day 14 = Sat 7/11) **Emphasis:** Speaking Task 1 (Listen & Repeat). Shadowing intensified. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing remain floor (and Shadowing today becomes *the* training, not warm-up). **Deliverables:** Listen & Repeat exact-match rate ≥ 80% on a 7-item fresh set + auditory memory span of 12+ words + clear consonant articulation under speed.

1 • Why this chapter exists

The new TOEFL 2026 Speaking Section is **7 Listen & Repeat items + 4 Interview items**. There is **no preparation time** for either. The Listen & Repeat task tests:

- **Auditory memory** (can you hold 8–15 words in working memory for ~3 sec)
- **Pronunciation fidelity** (consonant clusters, final consonants, linked sounds)
- **Prosody match** (stress, rhythm, intonation)
- **Speed of decoding** (no time to “think about” what you heard)

These are **exactly** what shadowing trains. Hamada (2016) and the 2025 Tandfon-line systematic review converge: 4–6 weeks of daily shadowing → measurable gains on all four. This chapter doubles down.

2 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — L&R exact-match rate $\geq 80\%$:** 7-item fresh set, recorded, scored by AI + self
 - **G2 — Auditory memory span:** can repeat a 12-word novel sentence after one hearing, with ≤ 2 word errors
 - **G3 — Consonant clarity:** final consonants and *th / v / r* sounds intelligible to AI scorer
 - **G4 — Shadowing volume:** ≥ 14 sessions in chapter (= daily), with last-week recordings noticeably better than first-week
 - **G5 — Other skills maintained:** Reading Module 1 still $\geq 80\%$; Listening lecture still $\geq 5/6$
 - **G6 — Interview not neglected:** at least 4 Interview practice sessions completed (prep for Ch.6)
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Speaking L&R emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Shadowing time doubles** — go from 15 min $\rightarrow$ **30 min** every day. The block 0:15–0:45 is all shadowing.
2. **Daily 5-min “sentence-level Listen & Repeat” drill** added between Anki and Shadowing — using **R-SHAD-3** (60-Second Science).
3. The Sunday MAIN slot becomes a **7-item L&R micro-mock**.

New daily template for Ch.4 (still 90 min total):

00:00–00:15	■	Anki
00:15–00:20	■	Sentence-level L&R drill (5 single-sentence repeats)
00:20–00:50	■	Shadowing (30 min – extended)
00:50–01:20	■	Day's MAIN skill
01:20–01:30	■	Day's SECONDARY + error log condensed

The MAIN/SECONDARY rotation continues; the SECONDARY block compresses from 20 to 10 min (just a touchpoint, not deep practice). Because Shadowing is doubled, L+S touchpoints are extreme.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday · MAIN = L&R 7-item micro-mock · SECONDARY = Writing — Email**

- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = **Speaking — Interview**
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = **Speaking — L&R deep drill** · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = **Speaking — Interview**
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined (lecture summary) · SECONDARY = Writing

Weekly counts (incl. doubled Shadowing as L+S): S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined + 14 shadow + 7 sentence drills = saturated; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC = 3; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined + 14 shadows = 17 touches; W = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC = 3. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Sun 6/28 — L&R micro-mock + Shadowing extended

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new, prioritize Barron's TOEFL
 - ☐ **0:15–0:20 Sentence-level L&R drill** — Open **R-SHAD-3** (60-Second Science). Play any episode. Pick 5 sentences (~8–15 words each). For each: pause after the sentence → repeat aloud from memory → re-listen.
 - ☐ **0:20–0:50 Shadowing 30 min** — Pick a 5-min TED-Ed (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>). Run **3-pass protocol twice** (= 6 passes total): each cycle is blind → transcript → record-compare.
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R 7-item micro-mock — R-OFF-1** TestReady → Speaking → Listen & Repeat task. Record each. Upload to **R-AI-1** PrepEx for scoring. Log exact-match counts.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — quick 1 Build-a-Sentence + error log
-

Day 2 · Mon 6/29 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki
 - ☐ **0:15–0:20** Sentence-level L&R drill
 - ☐ **0:20–0:50** Shadowing (30 min)
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage, strict 15 min + brief error attribution (the rest of the block).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 5 + error log
-

 Day 3 · Tue 6/30 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview)

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Listening MAIN** — 1 lecture + 1 conversation from **R-OFF-1**.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Interview** — Petra **R-AI-1** Interview
× 2 questions + 1-line error log
-

 Day 4 · Wed 7/1 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Writing MAIN** — Discussion, 10 min strict, score via **R-AI-2**.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Reading SECONDARY** — 1 Complete-the-Words paragraph + error log
-

 Day 5 · Thu 7/2 — S MAIN (L&R deep drill) / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R deep drill** — 14 items total: 7 from **R-OFF-1** TestReady L&R + 7 from **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new). For each item, do 2 takes: blind take → re-listen → corrected take. Compare both recordings.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 short conversation set + error log
-

 Day 6 · Fri 7/3 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview)

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Interview** — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 7 · Sat 7/4 — L+S combined / W secondary

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L+S combined** — Pick 10-min TED talk. Listen once, take notes. Record 90-sec spoken summary. Re-listen to verify.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Writing SECONDARY** — Email 10 min + weekly mini-review
-

 Day 8 · Sun 7/5 — L&R micro-mock (compare to Day 1)

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R micro-mock** — 7-item fresh set. Score. **Compare exact-match count to Day 1.**
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY + error log
-

 Day 9 · Mon 7/6 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20** Reading MAIN — 1 passage, strict 15 min.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 5 + error log
-

 Day 10 · Tue 7/7 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview)

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20** Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra Interview × 2 + error log
-

 Day 11 · Wed 7/8 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20** Writing MAIN — Discussion, 10 min.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — 1 Complete-the-Words drill + error log
-

 Day 12 · Thu 7/9 — S MAIN (L&R deep drill v2) / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R deep drill v2** — Today add **speed pressure**: play the audio at 1.1× (in TestReady use browser playback speed, or download audio and use Audacity/VLC). 14 items.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 conversation + error log
-

 Day 13 · Fri 7/10 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Sentence drill + Shadowing 30 min
- ☐ **0:50–1:20** Reading MAIN — 1 passage.

- ☐ 1:20–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

🇨🇳 Day 14 · Sat 7/11 — 🎯 Bi-week review + Showcase L&R + Listening preserve mock

- ☐ 0:00–0:15 Anki + reviews
 - ☐ 0:15–0:20 Sentence drill (one last time)
 - ☐ 0:20–0:50 Shadowing 30 min
 - ☐ 0:50–1:15 🎯 **Showcase L&R**: 7-item fresh set. Score. Goal: $\geq 80\%$ exact match.
 - ☐ 1:15–1:30 Quick **Listening preserve drill** (5 items from a fresh **R-OFF-1** lecture, no notes today — just see if accuracy holds) + Ch.4 Review Card
-

5 · Ch.4 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.4 Review (7/11)

Goal: Listen & Repeat exact-match $\geq 80\%$

- Day 1 baseline: __ / 7
- Day 8 mid-point: __ / 7
- Day 14 showcase: __ / 7 → %: __
- ****PASS**** ($\geq 80\%$) / ****HOLD**** (60–80%) / ****REDO**** ($< 60\%$)

Diagnostic

- Most common L&R failure mode: _____ (memory drop / pronunciation / speed / stress)
- 12-word novel sentence test (one trial today): repeated with __ errors
- Listening preserve drill score: __ / 5

Shadowing reflection

- Re-listened to Day 1 vs Day 13 recording — visible improvement? Yes / Partial / No
- If "No" → diagnose: am I doing the 3-pass protocol fully? Recording every session?

Modification orders for Ch.5 (Writing – Email + Build a Sentence)

- If L&R $< 80\%$ → keep 30-min Shadowing daily in Ch.5 (don't drop to 15)

- If memory drop dominant → daily "11+ word sentence" repetition drill, 5 sentences
 - If pronunciation dominant → add 5-min minimal-pair drill (see resource note below)
-

6 • Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **Recording is not optional.** You can't hear your own pronunciation errors live — only on playback. If you skip recording, the chapter doesn't work.
2. **3-pass protocol matters.** "Blind shadow only" gives ~50% of the benefit. The transcript pass exposes what you missed; the record-compare pass closes the loop.
3. **Don't memorize sentences.** L&R items are random. The skill is *generalized auditory memory*, not "I happen to know this sentence."
4. **Match stress, not just words.** AI scorers (and ETS) weigh prosody. Saying every syllable correctly but flat = lower score than 1 word wrong + good stress.
5. **Minimal-pair work** if pronunciation is your bottleneck: free resource is **Cambridge Sounds Pronunciation Drills** (search YouTube) — focus on /θ/ / ð/ /r/ /l/ /v/ /w/.
6. **Don't sacrifice Reading/Listening this chapter.** The plan keeps them at MAIN slots for a reason — gains evaporate fast.

Ch.5 • Writing — Email + Build a Sentence (7/12 – 7/25)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 7/12, Day 14 = Sat 7/25) **Emphasis:** Writing — Email task + Build a Sentence sub-task. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing remain floor (Shadowing resets to 15 min). **Deliverables:** Email 100 words in ≤ **10 min** reliably + Build-a-Sentence ≥ 9/10 + Milestone 2 (Listening ≥ 24/30 raw, L&R ≥ 80%) hit on Day 14.

1 • Why Email is its own chapter

In the new TOEFL 2026 Writing section, Email is **its own scored task** (not a warm-up). It tests:

- **Register awareness** (professor vs. peer vs. admin staff)
- **Functional clarity** (greeting → context → request → close)

- **Polite directness** — neither blunt nor over-padded
- **Grammar and word choice under time pressure** (10 min hard ceiling)

Build a Sentence tests pure **syntactic competence** — word-order under time pressure. Both reward **clean, simple structures** over showy vocabulary.

2 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Email 100 words ≤ 10 min:** reliably (3+ successful runs in chapter)
 - **G2 — Email register:** 3 distinct register exemplars written (formal-prof / semi-formal-TA / peer)
 - **G3 — Build a Sentence:** ≥ 9/10 on a fresh 10-item set
 - **G4 — Milestone 2 (Listening ≥ 24/30 raw):** showcase Listening mock on Day 14
 - **G5 — Milestone 2 (L&R ≥ 80%):** 7-item set on Day 14
 - **G6 — Discussion not neglected:** at least 4 Discussion practice runs completed
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Writing — Email emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Shadowing resets to 15 min** (Ch.4 doubled it; now back to floor).
2. **Daily “1 Email or 5 Build-a-Sentence items” micro-drill** between Anki and Shadowing (10 min).
3. **Sunday MAIN** = Email under exam conditions + immediate AI feedback review.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Writing — Email + feedback review** · SECONDARY = Short Listening mock (6 items)
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = **Writing — Build a Sentence**
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = **Writing — Email** · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined · SECONDARY = **Writing — Discussion**

Weekly counts: W = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 Sat-SEC + 7 micro-drills = 11 touches; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC = 3; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined + 1 Sun-SEC = 4; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

17 Day 1 · Sun 7/12 — Email exam-condition mock + feedback

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new (continue Barron's TOEFL)
 - ☐ **0:15–0:25 Writing micro-drill** — Build a Sentence × 5 items (**R-OFF-1** Writing practice).
 - ☐ **0:25–0:40 Shadowing 15 min** — back to baseline. TED-Ed (**R-SHAD-1**) 5-min video, 3-pass protocol.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Writing MAIN — Email — R-OFF-1** TestReady → Writing → Email. **Strict 10 min.** Then immediately upload to **R-AI-2** (FluentPrep). Spend the rest of the slot reading the rubric breakdown and noting 2 concrete improvements.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 conversation set (5 items, ~10 min) + error log
-

17 Day 2 · Mon 7/13 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY (Build a Sentence)

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki
 - ☐ **0:15–0:25 Writing micro-drill** — 1 Email outline only (greeting / context / ask / close — 5 lines, 3 min)
 - ☐ **0:25–0:40 Shadowing**
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage, strict 15 min, + attribution.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence** × 10 items + error log
-

17 Day 3 · Tue 7/14 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Listening MAIN** — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2 + error log
-

 Day 4 · Wed 7/15 — W MAIN (Email) / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Writing MAIN — Email** — pick a register you haven't practiced (e.g., **request to a TA** if Day 1 was **professor**). 10 min strict. **R-AI-2** feedback.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Reading SECONDARY** — 1 Complete-the-Words drill + error log
-

 Day 5 · Thu 7/16 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Speaking MAIN** — Listen & Repeat × 7 + Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 lecture + error log
-

 Day 6 · Fri 7/17 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** 1 passage.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2 + error log
-

 Day 7 · Sat 7/18 — L+S combined / W secondary (Discussion)

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 L+S combined** — TED talk 10–15 min, 90-sec spoken summary.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY — Discussion** — 200-word prompt, 10 min. **R-AI-2.** + weekly mini-review.
-

 Day 8 · Sun 7/19 — Email + feedback review v2

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Writing MAIN — Email. Goal today: compare against Day 1 Email** — paste both into **R-AI-5** (ChatGPT/Claude) and ask “which is more natural, which has clearer asks, what specifically improved?”
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 conversation + error log
-

 Day 9 · Mon 7/20 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing

- ☐ 0:40–1:10 Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 + error log
-

 Day 10 · Tue 7/21 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:40–1:10 Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 11 · Wed 7/22 — W MAIN (Email register variety) / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:40–1:10 Writing MAIN — Email. Pick a 3rd register (e.g., **classmate group-project coordination**). 10 min strict. **R-AI-2**.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 Reading SECONDARY — 1 Complete-the-Words OR 1 **R-REAL-3** article + error log
-

 Day 12 · Thu 7/23 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:40–1:10 Speaking MAIN — Listen & Repeat × 7 (keep L&R sharp) + Interview × 2.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture + error log
-

 Day 13 · Fri 7/24 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:40–1:10 Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 14 · Sat 7/25 — 🎯 Milestone 2 mock + Bi-week review

Milestone 2 (combined): Listening showcase + L&R showcase.

- ☐ 0:00–0:15 Anki + reviews
- ☐ 0:15–0:30 Shadowing
- ☐ 0:30–1:15 🎯 Milestone 2 mock:

- Full Listening Section (both modules) from **R-OFF-1** → target: raw $\geq 24/30$
 - 7-item L&R fresh set → target: exact-match $\geq 80\%$
 - ☐ **1:15–1:30** Ch.5 Review Card
-

5 · Ch.5 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.5 Review (7/25) – Milestone 2

Milestone 2 results

- Listening raw: __ / 30 → ****PASS**** (≥ 24) / ****HOLD**** (20–23) / ****REDO**** (< 20)
- L&R exact-match: __ / 7 → ****PASS**** ($\geq 80\%$) / ****HOLD**** / ****REDO****

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Email 100 words ≤ 10 min reliably (3+ runs)
- [] G2 3 register exemplars written (professor / TA / peer)
- [] G3 Build-a-Sentence $\geq 9/10$ fresh
- [] G4 Listening $\geq 24/30$
- [] G5 L&R $\geq 80\%$
- [] G6 ≥ 4 Discussion practice runs done

Email diagnostic

- Strongest register: _____
- Weakest register: _____ – fix: _____
- AI rubric area most often flagged: _____ (delivery / vocabulary / grammar / task achievement)

Modification orders for Ch.6 (Speaking – Interview + AI dialogue)

- If Milestone 2 Listening REDO → re-introduce L MAIN $\times 3$ /week in Ch.6
 - If L&R REDO → keep 30-min Shadowing in Ch.6 (rollback to Ch.4 style)
 - If Email register inconsistent → add 1 register-specific Email/week in Ch.6
-

6 · Common pitfalls

1. **Email is short — don't pad.** 100 words means 100 words. AI scorers (and ETS) penalize padding (“I would like to take this opportunity to...”). Be functional.

2. **Greeting + close take 15% of your word count.** Budget for it. Don't waste space on flourishes.
3. **Build a Sentence is grammar, not style.** If you miss items, drill **word order** (subject-verb-object inversions, adverb placement, comparatives) — don't add vocabulary.
4. **AI scoring on Email is mediocre** — heavily weight your own re-read. ChatGPT/Claude are better for “is this natural?” than for numeric scores.
5. **Don't let L&R rot.** It needed 14 days of intensity to build; it can lose 30% in 14 days of neglect. Keep the L&R micro-drill alive in Ch.5+.

Ch.6 · Speaking — Interview + AI Dialogue (7/26 – 8/8)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 7/26, Day 14 = Sat 8/8) **Emphasis:** Speaking Task 2 (Interview, 45-sec spontaneous answers). Heavy use of conversational AI.
Skill coverage: Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing floor.
Deliverables: 45-sec Interview answers with reliable **Idea / Reason / Tie-in** structure + 4 distinct topic categories rehearsed + AI delivery score trending up across chapter.

1 · Why Interview is hard (and why AI helps)

The new TOEFL 2026 Interview task asks 4 questions, each 45 sec, **with no preparation time**. ETS samples cluster into 3 styles:

- **Opinion/preference:** “Do you prefer studying alone or in a group? Why?”
- **Memory/experience:** “Describe a place you visited that surprised you.”
- **Lifestyle/routine:** “How do you usually relax after a stressful week?”

Standard prep mistake: students “prepare” 50 canned topics. The new AI scorer **detects canned answers** and penalizes them. What works instead:

1. **Structural fluency** — Idea (0–15s) → Reason (15–30s) → Tie-in (30–45s). Apply *any* topic, on the fly.
2. **Volume of spontaneous reps** — only a conversational AI (**R-AI-1 PrepEx Petra**) can give you 50+ unique reps in 2 weeks.
3. **Delivery > complexity** — clarity, pace, intelligibility beat vocabulary fireworks.

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — Interview structure:** Idea / Reason / Tie-in framing visible in $\geq 80\%$ of recordings
 - **G2 — Topic breadth:** 4 categories rehearsed — opinion / memory / lifestyle / hypothetical
 - **G3 — AI delivery score:** Petra/FluentPrep “Delivery” score trends up across chapter
 - **G4 — Time control:** all 4 answers land 40–45 sec (no truncation, no run-over)
 - **G5 — L&R doesn’t regress:** a weekly 7-item L&R drill stays $\geq 80\%$
 - **G6 — Other skills maintained:** Reading, Listening, Writing rotation intact
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Speaking — Interview emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Daily 10-min Petra (R-AI-1) Interview session** is added between Anki and Shadowing.
2. **Sunday MAIN** = 4-item Interview micro-mock (mimics real test).
3. **Recording archive:** every Interview recording saved with date and topic; weekly comparison built into Day 7/14.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Interview 4-item mock** · SECONDARY = Writing — Email
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = **Speaking — Interview deep drill**
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = **Speaking — Interview + L&R refresh** · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined · SECONDARY = Writing — Discussion

Weekly counts: S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined + 7 Petra micro = 11; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined; W = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Sun 7/26 — Interview 4-mock baseline

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki
- ☐ **0:15–0:25 Petra (R-AI-1) Interview** — 2 questions, full 45 sec each. Save recordings.
- ☐ **0:25–0:40** Shadowing 15 min (TED-Ed)
- ☐ **0:40–1:10 Interview 4-mock — R-OFF-1** TestReady → Speaking → Interview, 4 questions in a row. Record each. Then upload to **R-AI-2** (FluentPrep) for full rubric scoring.
- ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY** — Email 10 min + error log

Baseline log:

Day 1 Interview Baseline

- Q1 (opinion): Delivery ___ Language ___ Topic ___
 - Q2 (memory): Delivery ___ Language ___ Topic ___
 - Q3 (lifestyle): ___
 - Q4 (hypothetical): ___
 - Most common feedback: _____
-

Day 2 · Mon 7/27 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 + error log
-

Day 3 · Tue 7/28 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview deep drill)

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Interview deep drill** — 4 Petra questions, all **lifestyle** category today. Focus: Tie-in clarity (30–45 sec).
-

Day 4 · Wed 7/29 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:40–1:10** Writing MAIN — Discussion, 10 min.

- ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — Complete-the-Words OR **R-REAL-3** article + error log
-

 Day 5 · Thu 7/30 — S MAIN (Interview + L&R refresh) / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Speaking MAIN** —
 - 4 Interview questions (mixed categories) on **R-OFF-1**
 - + **7-item L&R refresh** (keep Ch.4 gain alive)
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture + error log
-

 Day 6 · Fri 7/31 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra Interview × 2 + error log
-

 Day 7 · Sat 8/1 — L+S combined / W secondary

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 L+S combined** — TED talk 10–15 min, 90-sec spoken summary, **then** answer one Petra Interview question on the talk's topic. Notice: how much does fresh-vocabulary exposure help your spontaneous output?
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Discussion, 10 min. Weekly mini-review.
-

 Day 8 · Sun 8/2 — Interview 4-mock v2 (compare to Day 1)

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Interview 4-mock v2** — fresh 4 questions. **Re-listen to Day 1 recording first**, then go. Score via **R-AI-2**.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Email + error log
-

 Day 9 · Mon 8/3 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
- ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 + error log

 Day 10 · Tue 8/4 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview deep drill, opinion only)

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Interview** — 4 Petra questions, all **opinion** category. Focus: stating a clear stance in the first 5 sec.
-

 Day 11 · Wed 8/5 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Writing MAIN — Discussion, 10 min.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — 1 Complete-the-Words + error log
-

 Day 12 · Thu 8/6 — S MAIN (Interview + L&R) / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Speaking MAIN — 4 Interview + 7 L&R items.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture + error log
-

 Day 13 · Fri 8/7 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview, hypothetical category)

- ☐ Anki + Petra Interview ×2 + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — 4 Petra **hypothetical** questions (“If you could ... what would you do?”). + error log
-

 Day 14 · Sat 8/8 — 🎯 Bi-week review + Interview showcase

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + reviews
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 🎯 Interview showcase** — 4 fresh **R-OFF-1** Interview questions, recorded, submitted to **R-AI-2** for full scoring. **Compare to Day 1 baseline.**
- ☐ **1:00–1:30** Ch.6 Review Card + **L&R preservation check** (7 items, fresh, target ≥ 75%).

5 · Ch.6 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.6 Review (8/8)

Showcase Interview results

- Q1 (opinion): Delivery __ / 4 Language __ / 4 Topic __ / 4
- Q2 (memory): ____
- Q3 (lifestyle): ____
- Q4 (hypothetical): ____
- AI Delivery score trend across chapter (Day 1 vs Day 14): __ → __

L&R preservation check

- Day 14 L&R: __ / 7 (target ≥ 75% to confirm no regression)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Idea/Reason/Tie-in visible in ≥ 80% recordings
- [] G2 4 categories practiced
- [] G3 Delivery score trending up
- [] G4 All answers 40–45 sec
- [] G5 L&R preserved
- [] G6 R/L/W rotation intact

Modification orders for Ch.7 (Writing – Discussion)

- If Interview structure inconsistent → add Idea/Reason/Tie-in template card to Anki
 - If L&R dropped → reintroduce Shadowing 30-min daily in Ch.7
 - If hypothetical category weakest → daily 1 hypothetical Petra question in Ch.7
-

6 · Common pitfalls

1. **The new test penalizes canned answers.** Don't memorize 50 sample answers. Memorize the **structure** (15-15-15 sec).
2. **AI Petra is not ETS — but the gap doesn't matter.** What you're training is fluency volume. 50 Petra reps > 5 perfect ETS-scored attempts.
3. **Time mis-management is the #1 fail.** Practice with a visible timer. Stop talking the second the 45 sec mark hits — train the reflex.
4. **Hesitations are fine; restarts are not.** “Um, well, I think...” is normal speech. “Wait, let me start over” tanks the score. Practice **committing** to whatever answer falls out of your mouth.

5. **Don't drift back to Independent Speaking templates.** Those are extinct in the new format. The AI scorer flags template-y openings ("In my opinion, the most important factor...").

Ch.7 · Writing — Academic Discussion (8/9 – 8/22)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 8/9, Day 14 = Sat 8/22) **Emphasis:** Writing Task 3 — Academic Discussion (200-word forum post in 10 min). **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing floor. **Deliverables:** Discussion 200 words in ≤ 10 min with clear PEEL structure + Milestone 3 (Email ≤ 10 min, Discussion ≤ 10 min on Day 14) + integrated reading–writing connection drilled.

1 · What the Discussion task actually tests

The Academic Discussion task gives a professor's forum prompt + 2 student posts. You write a **200-word reply** that:

- **Takes a clear position** (agree with student A / B, or third stance)
- **Adds new reasoning** (not just restating either student)
- **Cites or builds on at least one student's idea** to show engagement
- **Uses academic register** (formal but not stilted; no slang, no contractions)

The AI scorer rewards: **stance clarity, idea novelty, logical structure, and natural academic English.** It penalizes: padding, templates, off-topic riffs, and copying from the prompts.

The PEEL frame (works for any prompt without being a template): - **Point** — your stance, one sentence, in the first 30 sec of writing - **Evidence** — concrete example, study, scenario, or analogy - **Explanation** — why the evidence supports your stance - **Link** — tie back to a student post + close

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — Discussion 200 words ≤ 10 min:** reliably (3+ runs in chapter)
- **G2 — PEEL visible:** all chapter Discussion drafts have all 4 PEEL elements identifiable

- **G3 — Milestone 3 met:** Email $\leq$ 10 min AND Discussion $\leq$ 10 min on Day 14
 - **G4 — Vocabulary level:** AI rubric “Language Use” trending up; $\geq$ 5 chapter-vocab words used per draft
 - **G5 — Reading–Writing link:** after Reading practice, can paraphrase passage thesis in 1 sentence
 - **G6 — Other skills maintained:** Speaking, Listening rotation intact
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Discussion emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Daily 5-min “1-paragraph PEEL drill”** between Anki and Shadowing — pick a random thesis, write one PEEL paragraph (no full 200 words).
2. **Sunday MAIN** = Discussion under strict exam conditions + AI review.
3. **Wednesday MAIN** also Discussion — two structured practice runs per week.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Writing — Discussion exam-mock** · SECONDARY = Short Listening drill
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing — Email
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking — Interview
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = **Writing — Discussion** · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined · SECONDARY = **Writing — Build a Sentence + Email**

Weekly counts: W = 2 MAIN + 2 SEC + 7 PEEL micro-drills = 11; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined + 1 SEC = 4; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

 **Day 1 · Sun 8/9 — Discussion exam-mock baseline**

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki

- ☐ **0:15–0:20 PEEL micro-drill** — pick random topic (“Should universities require physical education?”), write one PEEL paragraph (~80 words). 5 min strict.
- ☐ **0:20–0:35 Shadowing** 15 min
- ☐ **0:35–1:10 Writing MAIN — Discussion exam-mock — R-OFF-1**
TestReady → Writing → Academic Discussion. **Strict 10 min.** Score via **R-AI-2** (FluentPrep).
- ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 lecture (6 items) + error log

Baseline log:

Day 1 Discussion Baseline

- Words written: ____ (target 180–220)
 - Time used: ____ min
 - AI rubric: Task Achievement ____ / Coherence ____ / Language Use ____ / Vocabulary ____
 - PEEL elements present? P ____ E ____ E ____ L ____
-

Day 2 · Mon 8/10 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY (Email)

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Reading MAIN** — 1 passage, strict 15 min, + **paraphrase passage thesis** in 1 sentence after.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY** — Email 10 min + error log
-

Day 3 · Tue 8/11 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Listening MAIN** — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2 + error log
-

Day 4 · Wed 8/12 — W MAIN (Discussion v2) / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:35–1:10 Writing MAIN — Discussion v2. Today’s focus: stance clarity in opening sentence.** AI feedback specifically on “Topic Development / Task Achievement.”
- ☐ **1:10–1:30 Reading SECONDARY** — Complete-the-Words OR **R-REAL-3** article + error log

 Day 5 · Thu 8/13 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Speaking MAIN — Listen & Repeat × 7 + Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture + error log
-

 Day 6 · Fri 8/14 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage. Today try: read passage **first**, then write a 1-paragraph PEEL stance on the passage's central claim (instead of the standard items). Tests reading-writing transfer.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 7 · Sat 8/15 — L+S combined / W secondary (Build + Email)

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** L+S combined — TED talk 10–15 min, 90-sec spoken summary.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 5 + 1 Email outline. Weekly mini-review.
-

 Day 8 · Sun 8/16 — Discussion mock v3 (compare to Day 1)

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Discussion mock v3. Re-read Day 1 draft first**, then go. Score. **Compare AI rubric scores side-by-side.**
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY + error log
-

 Day 9 · Mon 8/17 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Email 10 min + error log
-

 Day 10 · Tue 8/18 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 11 · Wed 8/19 — W MAIN (Discussion v4) / R SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Discussion v4** — today: **third-stance** practice. Don't agree with student A or B — propose a synthesis. 10 min strict.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — Complete-the-Words + error log
-

 Day 12 · Thu 8/20 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Speaking MAIN — Interview × 4 + 7 L&R refresh.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture + error log
-

 Day 13 · Fri 8/21 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 14 · Sat 8/22 — 🎯 Milestone 3 + Bi-week review

Milestone 3: Both Writing tasks under exam time.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–0:45** 🎯 **Email mock** — strict 10 min. Target: ≤ 10 min.
 - ☐ **0:45–1:00** 🎯 **Discussion mock** — strict 10 min. Target: ≤ 10 min + PEEL visible.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:30** Ch.7 Review Card
-

5 · Ch.7 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.7 Review (8/22) – Milestone 3

Milestone 3 results

- Email: __ words in __ min – ****PASS**** (≤ 10 min, ~100 words) / ****HOLD**** / ****REDO****
- Discussion: __ words in __ min – ****PASS**** (≤ 10 min, 180–220 words, PEEL visible) / ****HOLD**** / ****REDO****

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Discussion 200 words ≤ 10 min (3+ runs)
- [] G2 PEEL visible in all drafts
- [] G3 Milestone 3 met
- [] G4 Language Use score trending up
- [] G5 Can paraphrase passage thesis in 1 sentence
- [] G6 Speaking/Listening rotation maintained

Writing diagnostic

- Strongest of 3 tasks (Email / Build-a-Sentence / Discussion):

- Weakest: _____ – root cause: _____
- AI rubric area most often flagged across chapter: _____

Modification orders for Ch.8 (Adaptive Module 1 mastery)

- If Milestone 3 REDO on either task → add 1 Email or Discussion micro-mock per Ch.8 week
- If PEEL inconsistent → write 2 PEEL frames daily in Ch.8 (1 minute each, in Anki)
- If language use lagging → focus Anki on ****academic phrase bank**** instead of new vocab

6 · Common pitfalls

1. **200 words is not aspirational — it's the contract.** Under 180 → underweight. Over 230 → wasting time on a clock you don't have.
2. **Don't restate the prompt.** AI penalizes copy-paste. Paraphrase or skip the restatement.
3. **PEEL is a frame, not a template.** Don't write "My point is X. My evidence is Y. My explanation is Z. My link is W." Write **as if having a real opinion** — but cover all 4 functions.

4. **Cite a student post** by name or paraphrase: “Building on Sarah’s point about ____.” This single move bumps Task Achievement scores reliably.
5. **Read aloud during the 30-sec re-read window.** Hearing your sentence catches errors your eye misses. (You can mouth silently in the test.)
6. **Don’t over-vocabulary.** A perfect simple sentence beats a clumsy showy one. AI rubric punishes misused fancy words harder than absent ones.

Ch.8 · Adaptive Realism — Module 1 Mastery (8/23 – 9/5)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 8/23, Day 14 = Sat 9/5) **Emphasis:** Module 1 accuracy across all 4 skills (with Listening/Reading getting most adaptive-specific drilling, since those are the only truly adaptive sections). **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing floor. **Deliverables:** Module 1 accuracy targets met on **every** skill area + careless-error rate cut by $\geq 50\%$ vs Ch.1 baseline + transition from “skill building” to “test performance” mindset.

1 · Why Module 1 is the score lever

The 2026 adaptive engine works like this:

1. You start Module 1 (mid-difficulty items).
2. The engine measures your accuracy on Module 1.
3. If you do well, Module 2 unlocks at **higher difficulty** — your score ceiling rises.
4. If you stumble in Module 1, Module 2 stays at lower difficulty — your ceiling caps.

Consequence: a “silly mistake” in Module 1 hurts more than an outright wrong answer in Module 2. The engine reads Module 1 stumbles as “this person doesn’t have mastery” → caps the ceiling.

This chapter rewires your practice toward **single-pass accuracy under exam conditions** — not “did I learn this concept” but “did I get it right the first time, under time, when it counted.”

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — Reading Module 1 accuracy:** $\geq 90\%$ on 3 separate fresh sets
 - **G2 — Listening Module 1 accuracy:** $\geq 85\%$ on 3 separate fresh sets
 - **G3 — Speaking L&R accuracy:** $\geq 85\%$ exact-match on 3 separate sets
 - **G4 — Writing Email + Discussion:** each completed in ≤ 9 min (1 min buffer below ceiling)
 - **G5 — Careless-error rate:** tagged “careless” errors $\leq 50\%$ of Ch.1 baseline
 - **G6 — Speed-accuracy decoupling:** can verbally explain when to slow down vs press on
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Module 1 emphasis across all skills)

Three changes:

1. Every MAIN block is “Module 1 only” — not full sections. Quality over volume.
2. **Daily 5-min “careless-error review”** between Anki and Shadowing — re-read yesterday’s tagged careless errors aloud, articulate the trap.
3. **Sunday MAIN** = mini-full mock (1 R Module 1 + 1 L Module 1 + 1 Email, all back-to-back, simulating fatigue stack).

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Mini-full mock** (R-M1 + L-M1 + Email) · SECONDARY = Discussion
- **Monday** · MAIN = **Reading Module 1** · SECONDARY = **Writing Build-a-Sentence**
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = **Listening Module 1** · SECONDARY = Speaking — Interview
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = **Writing Discussion** · SECONDARY = Reading Module 1 (timed accuracy drill)
- **Thursday** · MAIN = **Speaking L&R + Interview** · SECONDARY = Listening Module 1
- **Friday** · MAIN = **Reading Module 1** · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined (real material) · SECONDARY = **Writing — Email**

Weekly counts: R = 3 MAIN + 1 SEC; L = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined; W = 2 MAIN + 2 SEC; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

17 Day 1 · Sun 8/23 — Mini-full mock (fatigue-stack baseline)

- ☐ 0:00–0:15 Anki
- ☐ 0:15–0:20 **Careless-error review** — re-read your 3 most recent “careless” tagged errors aloud, articulate what you’ll do differently
- ☐ 0:20–0:35 Shadowing 15 min
- ☐ 0:35–1:10 **Mini-full mock:**
 - 1 Reading Module 1 set (10 items, 18 min strict)
 - 1 Listening Module 1 set (10 items, ~15 min)
 - 1 Email (10 min)
 - **Source: R-OFF-1 TestReady. No breaks.**
- ☐ 1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY — Discussion 10 min + error log

Baseline log:

Day 1 Mini-mock Baseline

- Reading M1: __ / __ → %: __
 - Listening M1: __ / __ → %: __
 - Email AI rubric overall: __
 - Felt: how was fatigue by the Email task? __
-

17 Day 2 · Mon 8/24 — R-M1 MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:35–1:10 **Reading Module 1 MAIN** — 1 Module 1 set, strict 18 min. Goal: **single-pass accuracy ≥ 90%**. Score, then attribute every error.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 + error log
-

17 Day 3 · Tue 8/25 — L-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ 0:35–1:10 **Listening Module 1 MAIN** — 1 Module 1 set (1 lecture + 1 conversation). Goal: **≥ 85%**.
 - ☐ 1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Petra Interview × 2 + error log
-

 Day 4 · Wed 8/26 — Discussion MAIN / R-M1 SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Writing MAIN — Discussion** strict 10 min, target ≤ 9 min.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Reading Module 1 SECONDARY** — small 5-item drill, accuracy-focused (no time pressure). + error log
-

 Day 5 · Thu 8/27 — Speaking L&R + Interview MAIN / L-M1 SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Speaking MAIN** — 7 L&R items + 4 Interview items, all recorded, all scored via **R-AI-2**.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening Module 1 SECONDARY** — 1 conversation (5 items) + error log
-

 Day 6 · Fri 8/28 — R-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Reading Module 1** — new set, strict 18 min.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra $\times 2$ + error log
-

 Day 7 · Sat 8/29 — L+S combined / W secondary (Email)

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 L+S combined** — **R-REAL-4** MIT OCW 10-min lecture, notes, 90-sec spoken summary.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY** — Email 10 min + weekly mini-review
-

 Day 8 · Sun 8/30 — Mini-full mock v2 (compare to Day 1)

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Mini-full mock v2** — fresh sets. **Compare scores and felt-fatigue against Day 1.**
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Discussion** 10 min + error log
-

 Day 9 · Mon 8/31 — R-M1 MAIN / W SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading Module 1, strict 18 min.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 + error log
-

 Day 10 · Tue 9/1 — L-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Listening Module 1.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 11 · Wed 9/2 — Discussion MAIN / R-M1 SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Discussion 10 min, target ≤ 9 min.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading Module 1 SEC — 5-item drill + error log
-

 Day 12 · Thu 9/3 — Speaking MAIN / L-M1 SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Speaking — 7 L&R + 4 Interview.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening Module 1 SEC — 1 conv + error log
-

 Day 13 · Fri 9/4 — R-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

- ☐ Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading Module 1.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 + error log
-

 Day 14 · Sat 9/5 — 🎯 Module 1 showcase across 4 skills + Bi-week review

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + reviews
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing
- ☐ **0:30–1:15** 🎯 **Module 1 showcase** — 1 fresh set each: R-M1, L-M1, 7-item L&R, 1 Email (10 min). No breaks. Score all.
- ☐ **1:15–1:30** Ch.8 Review Card

5 · Ch.8 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.8 Review (9/5)

Module 1 showcase results

- Reading M1: ___ / 10 → %: ___ → PASS (≥ 90%) / HOLD / REDO
- Listening M1: ___ / 10 → %: ___ → PASS (≥ 85%) / HOLD / REDO
- L&R: ___ / 7 → %: ___ → PASS (≥ 85%) / HOLD / REDO
- Email: ___ min, ___ words, AI rubric overall ___

Careless-error rate

- Ch.1 baseline careless errors: ___
- Ch.8 careless errors this 14-day stretch: ___
- Reduction: ___% (*target ≥ 50% reduction*)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 R-M1 ≥ 90% on 3+ separate fresh sets
- [] G2 L-M1 ≥ 85% on 3+ separate fresh sets
- [] G3 L&R ≥ 85% on 3+ separate sets
- [] G4 Email & Discussion ≤ 9 min reliably
- [] G5 Careless rate halved vs Ch.1
- [] G6 Can articulate slow-down vs press-on heuristic

Modification orders for Ch.9 (Full mocks)

- If any Module 1 still REDO → add 1 R-M1 or L-M1 drill per Ch.9 week
- If careless rate stuck → start every Ch.9 mock with a 60-sec "deliberate slow-start" warm-up
- If Email/Discussion timing still >10 min → micro-drill 1 task daily on top of Ch.9 mocks

6 · Common pitfalls

1. **Don't speed up Module 1.** The engine doesn't care if you finish 30 seconds early. It cares about accuracy. Allocate generously, then re-check before submitting.
2. **Careless errors come in clusters.** When you misread one item, you're often in a low-attention state — the next 2–3 items are at risk too. Build a habit of taking a 5-sec micro-reset after every error you catch.

3. **Time is a tool, not a goal.** Don't say "I finished R-M1 in 14 min so I'm great." Say "I got 9/10 in 16 min so I'm great." Speed only matters if accuracy is locked.
4. **AI scoring is noisier than it looks.** Compare 3 attempts before trusting a trend. A single bad score doesn't mean regression.
5. **Don't burn out before Ch.9.** Ch.9 is full mocks ×4 — high-energy. If Ch.8 leaves you drained, you'll bomb Ch.9. Pace, hydrate, sleep.

Ch.9 · Full Mocks ×4 + Error Attribution (9/6 – 9/19)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Sun 9/6, Day 14 = Sat 9/19) **Emphasis:** Whole-test execution under real conditions; turning practice into score. **Skill coverage:** Mocks are inherently all-4-skill. Anki + Shadowing floor. **Deliverables:** 4 full mocks completed with score trend visible, stabilizing at ≥ 100 (target band) by Day 14 + thorough error-attribution log + exam-day routine rehearsed.

1 · The Ch.9 rhythm

This is the chapter where you stop “studying TOEFL” and start “executing TOEFL.”

Each mock cycle = 3 days: - **Mock Day:** 90 minutes, full simulation (single 90-min block, no phone, no music) - **Attribution Day:** the entire 90 minutes is spent **on the mock's errors** — not new practice - **Active recovery + targeted drill Day:** light Anki + Shadowing + 1 quick drill on the weakest skill the mock exposed

You do this 4 times ($3 \times 4 = 12$ days), leaving Day 13–14 for the final showcase mock + Bi-week review.

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — 4 full mocks completed:** all 4 done, all 4 scored
- **G2 — Stable mock score ≥ 100 :** Mocks 3 & 4 both ≥ 100 (or your target band)
- **G3 — Error attribution:** every wrong item in every mock has cause + planned fix
- **G4 — Exam-day routine:** a reproducible morning + transit + warm-up routine, tested
- **G5 — Time control:** all 4 mocks completed without running over total time

- **G6 — Stamina:** Mock 4 score within 3 points of Mock 3 (no late-mock fatigue dip)
-

3 · Mock-cycle schedule

- **Day 1 · Sun 9/6 — Mock 1** (90 min) + brief immediate score
- **Day 2 · Mon 9/7 — Attribution 1** (90 min, every error analyzed)
- **Day 3 · Tue 9/8 — Recovery + targeted drill** on Mock 1 weakest skill
- **Day 4 · Wed 9/9 — Mock 2**
- **Day 5 · Thu 9/10 — Attribution 2**
- **Day 6 · Fri 9/11 — Recovery + targeted drill**
- **Day 7 · Sat 9/12 — Light day — Anki + Shadowing + 1 Petra Interview round** (no full mock)
- **Day 8 · Sun 9/13 — Mock 3**
- **Day 9 · Mon 9/14 — Attribution 3**
- **Day 10 · Tue 9/15 — Recovery + targeted drill**
- **Day 11 · Wed 9/16 — Mock 4**
- **Day 12 · Thu 9/17 — Attribution 4**
- **Day 13 · Fri 9/18 — Recovery + targeted drill**
- **Day 14 · Sat 9/19 — Bi-week review + exam-day routine dress rehearsal**

All four skills are touched on every Mock Day (mock is whole-test). On Attribution and Recovery days, Anki + Shadowing maintain the L+S+vocab floor. Targeted drills rotate by chapter weakness.

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Sun 9/6 — Mock 1

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up (don't skip — these mocks happen in the same morning slot as the real exam)
- ☐ **0:15–1:45** 🎯 **Mock 1 — R-OFF-1 TestReady full adaptive mock.** 90 min, single sitting. **Treat as exam:**
 - Same time of day as real exam (~08:00 if you can)
 - No phone, no snacks mid-mock

- ▶ Use scratch paper for notes
- ▶ Stop immediately at the timer
- ☐ **Score block (post-90min):** Record scores immediately while fresh:

Mock 1 (9/6)

- Reading: __ / 30 (M1: __ / __, M2: __ / __)
 - Listening: __ / 30 (M1: __ / __, M2: __ / __)
 - Speaking: __ / 30 (L&R: __ / 7, Interview Delivery+Lang+Topic)
 - Writing: __ / 30 (Build: __, Email: __, Discussion: __)
 - Total: __ / 120
 - CEFR band: __
 - Felt energy at minute 45: __ / 10
 - Felt energy at minute 90: __ / 10
-

Day 2 · Mon 9/7 — Attribution 1

Today: no new mock items. Whole 90 min on Mock 1 errors.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + Shadowing 15 min
- ☐ **0:30–1:30 Attribution session.** For every wrong item:
 - ▶ Reading: which question type? Vocab / inference / detail / paragraph purpose / negative-fact / sentence-insert?
 - ▶ Listening: vocab / speed / inattention / accent / lost the structure?
 - ▶ Speaking: delivery / language / topic? Which task?
 - ▶ Writing: AI rubric tells you — note which rubric area was weakest.
- ☐ By end of session, fill in:

Mock 1 Attribution

- Weakest skill: _____
 - Most common error cause across skills: _____
 - 3 specific habit changes for Mock 2:
 1. _____
 2. _____
 3. _____
-

Day 3 · Tue 9/8 — Recovery + targeted drill

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing

- ☐ **0:30–1:10 Targeted drill on Mock 1 weakest skill** — 1 set of that skill's Module 1 only (or 7 L&R items / 1 Email + Discussion). Apply the 3 habit changes from yesterday.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Light Anki review + error log**
-

Day 4 · Wed 9/9 — Mock 2

- ☐ Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up
 - ☐ **0:15–1:45 🎯 Mock 2** — fresh test, same conditions. **Did the 3 habit changes show up?**
 - ☐ Score block (same template as Day 1)
-

Day 5 · Thu 9/10 — Attribution 2

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:30 Attribution session.** Compare to Mock 1: which weakness is resolved? Which is new?
 - ☐ **3 habit changes for Mock 3:**
 - 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Day 6 · Fri 9/11 — Recovery + targeted drill

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10 Drill weakest skill from Mock 2.**
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Error log**
-

Day 7 · Sat 9/12 — Light day

Real exams happen with **rest days before them**. Don't grind through Sat.

- ☐ Anki (full session, this is the easy part)
- ☐ Shadowing 15 min
- ☐ Petra Interview × 2 — keep speaking warm

- ☐ **No mocks, no full sections.** Walk, sleep, hydrate.
-

Day 8 · Sun 9/13 — Mock 3

- ☐ Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up
 - ☐ **0:15–1:45 🎯 Mock 3 — target ≥ 100 .**
 - ☐ Score block
-

Day 9 · Mon 9/14 — Attribution 3

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **Attribution session. Did you hit ≥ 100 ?** If yes, what stabilized? If no, what's the systematic gap?
 - ☐ **3 habit changes for Mock 4 (and the real exam):**
 - 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Day 10 · Tue 9/15 — Recovery + targeted drill

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10** Drill weakest skill from Mock 3
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Error log
-

Day 11 · Wed 9/16 — Mock 4

- ☐ Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up
 - ☐ **0:15–1:45 🎯 Mock 4 — target ≥ 100 AND within 3 points of Mock 3 (= stability).**
 - ☐ Score block
-

Day 12 · Thu 9/17 — Attribution 4

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing

- ☐ **Attribution session.** Final stable-state assessment. **Are the remaining errors systematic or random?** Random = ready. Systematic = one more drill target for Ch.10 (Final Week).
-

17 Day 13 · Fri 9/18 — Recovery + targeted drill

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10** Final drill on Mock 4 weakest skill — keep it light, this is taper
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Error log + start drafting your exam-day routine for tomorrow's rehearsal
-

17 Day 14 · Sat 9/19 — 🎯 Bi-week review + Exam-day dress rehearsal

Treat tomorrow's exam as if it were today.

- ☐ **Morning routine rehearsal:** wake up at the time you plan to wake up on exam day. Eat the same breakfast. Take the same transit (mentally walk through it if your test is at home).
 - ☐ **0:00–0:30** Anki + Shadowing — exactly as you would on exam morning
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Light warm-up** — 1 R-M1 set (no scoring, just to wake up the language brain). **Do NOT do a full mock.**
 - ☐ **1:00–1:30** Ch.9 Review Card + finalize the exam-day routine doc
-

5 · Ch.9 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.9 Review (9/19)

Mock scores

Mock	Date	R	L	S	W	Total	CEFR
1	9/6						
2	9/9						
3	9/13						
4	9/16						

- Trend: Mock 1 → Mock 4 score delta: ____
- Mocks 3 & 4 both ≥ 100 ? Yes / No
- Mock 4 vs Mock 3 within 3 points? Yes / No (stability check)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 4 mocks done
- [] G2 Mocks 3 & 4 ≥ 100
- [] G3 Every error attributed
- [] G4 Exam-day routine drafted and rehearsed
- [] G5 No timing overruns
- [] G6 Mock 4 stable vs Mock 3

Residual systematic errors (carry into Ch.10)

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Final Exam-Day Routine (draft)

- Wake time: ____
 - Breakfast: ____
 - Departure / setup: ____
 - On-arrival warm-up: ____ (Shadowing 5 min recommended)
 - During-test mantras: ____
-

6 • Common pitfalls

1. **Don't mock every day.** Mocks are exhausting. The 3-day cycle (mock / attribute / recover) is research-backed and matches your physical capacity.
2. **Attribution > new items.** A wrong answer with no attribution is a guaranteed repeat. A wrong answer with attribution is half-fixed already.
3. **AI scoring on Speaking/Writing has a 5-point error bar.** Don't panic over a 3-point dip between mocks. Look at the trend across all 4.
4. **The light day (Day 7) is non-negotiable.** Cumulative fatigue tanks Mocks 3–4. Trust the taper.
5. **Mock 4 within 3 points of Mock 3 = ready.** Score volatility means the system isn't stable yet. If Mock 4 swings ± 5 from Mock 3, examine: was it the mock content or your state?
6. **Don't compare to other test takers.** Your trend is the only data that matters.

Ch.10 · Final Week — Pre-Exam Tune-up (9/20 – 9/26)

Days: 7 (Day 1 = Sun 9/20 → Day 7 = Sat 9/26 = **EXAM DAY**) **Emphasis:** State management, micro-fixes only, no new heavy practice. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches all 4 skills, but lightly. **Deliverables:** Walk into the exam **rested, calibrated, and confident.**

1 · The taper logic

You've done 18 weeks of work. The skills are built. The neural pathways are laid. **Adding new practice in the final week shows up as fatigue, not score gains.**

This week's job is: 1. **Maintain** what you have (Anki, Shadowing, light skill touches) 2. **Sharpen** one or two systematic errors from Ch.9 attribution 3. **Rest** — sleep, hydration, low cognitive load 4. **Rehearse** the exam day until it feels routine

What NOT to do: - No full mocks after Wed (Day 4) - No new Anki cards after Wed (only reviews) - No new sources / decks / tools - No comparing yourself to other test takers online

2 · Daily checklists (7 days)

Day 1 · Sun 9/20 — Calibration day

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 10 new (half normal) + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing 15 min — a video you've shadowed before (no new material this week)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00** 1 R-M1 set (10 items, strict 18 min). **Goal: calibrate timing**, not score.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20** 1 L conversation set (5 items) + 2 Petra Interview questions.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Review yesterday's Ch.9 final attribution. Pick **one** systematic error to fix this week. Write it on a sticky note.
-

Day 2 · Mon 9/21 — Mini-mock (last full mock)

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up

- ☐ **0:15–1:45 Final mini-mock** — 1 Reading section + 1 Listening section (~60 min) + 1 Email + 1 Interview question. Roughly 75 min total. **This is the last full session.**
 - ☐ Score immediately. **Don't dwell** — if it dipped, that's normal pre-exam state.
-

Day 3 · Tue 9/22 — Targeted fix on the sticky note

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10 Targeted fix** — only the systematic error from Day 1 sticky note. Examples:
 - If “L lecture inference questions” → drill 3 lecture sets and only re-do the inference items
 - If “Discussion stance ambiguity” → write 3 PEEL paragraphs focused on opening-sentence stance
 - If “L&R memory drop on long sentences” → 10 sentence-level repetitions, 12+ word range
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 1 Email** (10 min strict) — last Email practice + error log
-

Day 4 · Wed 9/23 — Last full Speaking warm + Writing warm

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking**: 7 L&R + 4 Interview. **R-AI-2** scoring.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing**: 1 Discussion strict 10 min. **R-AI-2** scoring.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Review** week-to-date progress vs sticky note. **Do not add new fixes** — only refine the original one.
-

Day 5 · Thu 9/24 — Light day

2 days out. **Drop the load.**

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki** — **reviews only**, no new cards
- ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing** 15 min — your favorite clip, low effort
- ☐ **0:30–0:45 Listen** to one **R-SHAD-3** 60-sec Science episode + summarize aloud in one sentence
- ☐ **0:45–1:00 Read** one **R-REAL-1** Economist Espresso brief (5 min)

- ☐ No drills. No mocks. **Get 8+ hours of sleep tonight.**
-

Day 6 · Fri 9/25 — Logistics + rest day

1 day out. **Rest > practice.**

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki reviews only
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — short, easy clip
 - ☐ **0:30–0:45 Logistics check:**
 - Test admission ticket / confirmation email — printed or screenshot
 - ID document — passport ready
 - Test center location + transit time + parking (or at-home: room cleared, browser/system check completed in TestReady)
 - Exam-day breakfast bought / planned
 - Clothes laid out
 - Phone alarm set for **wake time**
 - **No screens after 22:00.** Sleep early.
 - ☐ No practice items today.
-

Day 7 · Sat 9/26 — 🎯 EXAM DAY

08:00 AM — TOEFL iBT 2026

Pre-exam (60–90 min before)

- ☐ Wake at your rehearsed time
- ☐ Same breakfast as your rehearsals
- ☐ **5-min Shadowing** — your favorite clip. Wakes up the language brain.
- ☐ **2-min Anki review** — quick scan of yesterday's reviews. No new cards.
- ☐ Mantra: *"Module 1 accuracy. Single-pass. Slow start. Trust the work."*

During the exam

- **Reading:** First 2 items, **deliberately read slowly.** Reset your reading speed before pace-setting.
- **Listening:** Notes from the first sentence. Don't wait to see if "it'll be important."
- **Speaking:**
 - L&R — breathe before each item, stay in the speaker's rhythm

- Interview — first 5 sec: state your stance clearly, then unfold
- **Writing:**
 - Email — greet / context / ask / close. Stop at 100 words.
 - Discussion — PEEL: Point in opening sentence. Build a Sentence — read each option twice.

After the exam

- Walk away. Don't re-litigate.
 - Eat something good.
 - Score arrives in 72 hours via **R-OFF-1**.
-

3 · Post-Exam (within 72 hours)

Exam Reflection

Score (when it arrives)

- Reading: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Listening: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Speaking: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Writing: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Total: __ / 120
- CEFR Overall: __

Comparison to Ch.9 mocks

- Best mock score: ____
- Real exam score: ____
- Delta: ____

What worked from this book

-
-

What I'd change for a retake (if any)

-
-

4 · If the score isn't what you wanted

1. **Wait 72 hours** before deciding anything. Initial reactions are biased by exhaustion.

2. **Look at the section breakdown.** A retake should target the weakest single section — not “study everything more.”
 3. **Retake window:** TOEFL iBT allows next-attempt registration 3 days after; the next test date is typically 1–3 weeks out. ETS scoring rules permit unlimited retakes.
 4. **Re-use this book.** Treat the weak section as a new Ch.2–Ch.9 mini-cycle (6 weeks). Skip the rest.
-

5 · The one thing to remember

You spent 132 days building infrastructure: Anki habit, Shadowing reflex, error attribution, weekly rotation, mock execution, taper discipline. The score is downstream of the system.

Trust the system. Execute the test.

Good luck. 🎯